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A Hybrid CNN-Transformer Approach for Breast Cancer Detection and Segmentation from Ultrasound Images

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Abstract

Breast cancer is one of the major causes of mortality among women around the world according to the WHO (World Health Organization). Treatment for breast cancer depends on the type of cancer, the patient, and its spread. Although breast cancer occurs in every country, with early and correct detection, there's a significant possibility in rising survival rate. This experimental research showcases a Hybrid CNN-Transformer Model which includes Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for feature extraction and Vision Transformers (ViTs) for generalized learning to improve the classification and segmentation of breast ultrasound images. The choice of a hybrid CNN-Transformer model is justified by the complementary strengths of both architectures—CNNs efficiently capture local spatial features, while Transformers enhance the model's ability to learn long-range dependencies and contextual information, which is critical in medical imaging.

To address clinical applicability, the study incorporates model interpretability by integrating attention visualization techniques that highlight regions of interest in ultrasound images, aiding clinicians in understanding AI decision-making. This level of transparency supports trust and facilitates adoption in clinical settings, where explainability is essential. The dataset used for training and testing consists of breast ultrasound images gathered from diverse sources; however, while it represents various tumor types and imaging conditions, some demographic and geographic limitations still exist, potentially affecting the model's generalizability across broader populations.

During segmentation and classification, challenges such as noise in ultrasound images, irregular tumor shapes, and variability in image quality were encountered. These were mitigated using pre-processing techniques, data augmentation, and a multi-scale feature learning strategy to improve model robustness and accuracy. Furthermore, the research explores the potential for integrating multi-modal imaging data (e.g., combining ultrasound with mammography or MRI) to enhance diagnostic performance. Although this integration could significantly improve accuracy, practical implementation in real-world workflows may face barriers such as differences in imaging formats, increased computational requirements, and the need for standardized protocols.

As an interpretable, scalable, and efficient solution for breast cancer detection, the developed system connects the gap between medical practice and AI research. By expanding the dataset, integrating multi-modal imaging techniques, and improving segmentation accuracy, the system is expected to strengthen with more diagnostic capabilities and better adapt to diverse clinical environments.

Keywords: Breast Cancer, Artificial Intelligence, Deep Learning, CNN-Transformer Hybrid Model, Ultrasound Imaging, Medical AI, Computer Vision, Full-Stack AI Platform

Contents

Abstract.....	2
Contents	3
List of Figures	5
1. Introduction.....	7
1.1 Background	7
1.1.1 Problem Statement and Objectives.....	9
1.1.1.1 Problem Statement.....	9
1.1.2 Objectives	10
2 Literature Review.....	11
2.1 Breast Cancer Detection & Segmentation in Medical Imaging.....	11
2.2 Deep Learning in Medical Image Analysis	12
2.3 Related Works	13
2.4 Hybrid CNN-Transformer Models in Medical Imaging	14
2.5 Challenges & Gaps in Existing Research.....	15
2.6 Summary & Research Justification	16
Key Findings.....	16
Justification for a Hybrid CNN-Transformer Approach	17
Addressing Existing Gaps and Contributes to the Field	18
3 Research Design	19
Deep Learning & AI Frameworks	20
3.1 Hybrid CNN-Transformer Model	22
3.2 Data Preprocessing Pipeline.....	22
3.3 Full-Stack Platform Design	24
.....	25
3.4 UML Diagrams	25
User Stories	25
Use Case Diagram	26
Use Case Descriptions	27
.....	28
UI Designs	29

	System Architecture Diagram	33
	Model Optimization Strategies	35
	Deployment & Real-World Integration	36
4	Methodology	37
5.1	Phase 1	41
5.2	Phase 2	45
5.3	Phase 3	49
5	Results and Discussion	59
	Limitations and Future Directions	61
6	Conclusion and Recommendations	61
7	Contributions	62
8	Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional Practice	63
9	Future Work (200)	64
10	Planning	66
5.1	Dissertation Plan (February 2025 - May 2025)	66
11	References	Error! Bookmark not defined.
12	Annex A	67
7.1	CN7000 MWPL Dissertation Proposal	68

List of Figures

Figure 1-Map of the global-wide female breast cancer cases in 2022 Estimated age-standardized rates of incidence (a) and mortality (b) (Kim et al., 2025)	8
Figure 2-Evolution of AI applications on breast cancer care (Chia and G. S., 2025)	9
Figure 3-Model Evaluation	17
Figure 4-Venn diagram	20
Figure 5-Hybrid Architecture	22
Figure 6-Data Processing Pipeline	23
Figure 7-Dataset	24
Figure 8-Web Platform	25
Figure 9-Userstory 1	25
Figure 10-Userstory 2	26
Figure 11-Userstory 3	26
Figure 12-Usecase Diagram	27
Figure 13-Description 1	28
Figure 14- Description 2	28
Figure 15-Description 3	28
Figure 16-SignIn	31
Figure 17-SignUp	29
Figure 18-Image upload	30
Figure 19-Results Page	31
Figure 20-Report page	31
Figure 21-Dashboard	32
Figure 22-Account page	33
Figure 23-System Architecture Diagram	34
Figure 24-Optimization Strategies	35
Figure 25-Deployment & Real-World Integration	36
Figure 26-DSR process	37
Figure 27-SDLC Waterfall Model	39
Figure 28-_mask.png	42
Figure 29-Image Preprocessing & Augmentation	42
Figure 30-Custom Keras layer	42
Figure 31-CNN backbone	43
Figure 32-Transformer (ViT) backbone	43
Figure 33-Merging CNN & Transformer Features	43
Figure 34-Dual-Input Data Generator	44
Figure 35-Early Stopping & Learning Rate Reduction	44
Figure 36-Sample image(CLAHE)	46
Figure 37-Code of (CLAHE)	46
Figure 38-Sample image(Elastic Transform)	46
Figure 39-Code of (Elastic Transform)	46
Figure 40-Sample image Gaussian Noise	46
Figure 41-Code of Gaussian Noise	46
Figure 42-Sample Image of Motion Blur	47

Figure 43-Code for Motion Blur	47
Figure 44-Sample Image of Simulated Occlusion	47
Figure 45-Code of Simulated Occlusion	47
Figure 46-Sample Image of Brightness Variation	47
Figure 47-Code for Brightness Variation	47
Figure 48-Original Image Sample	48
Figure 49-Equal sample distribution	48
Figure 50-Essential parameters	50
Figure 51-CLAHE (Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization)	50
Figure 52- BreastCancerDataset Class	51
Figure 53-Augmentation Techniques	51
Figure 54-Dataset Balancing	52
Figure 55-Dataset Split	52
Figure 56-Hybrid model	53
Figure 57-Model Training	54
Figure 58-Performance Comparison	55
Figure 59-Code for Comparison	55
Figure 60-Hybrid Results	55
Figure 61-ViT Results	55
Figure 62-Hybrid CNN+ViT Confusion Matrix	55
Figure 63-Hybrid CNN+ViT Results	56
Figure 64-ResNet18 Confusion Matrix	56
Figure 65-ResNet18 Results	56
Figure 66-ViT Confusion Matrix	56
Figure 67-ViT Results	56
Figure 68-Transformation	57
Figure 69-ElasticTransform	57
Figure 70-GaussNoise	57
Figure 71- code clahe	57
Figure 72- Original Image	58
Figure 73-Noise Reduction	58
Figure 74-CNN layers and self-attention maps	58
Figure 75-Transparent visualization	58
Figure 76-High accuracy + Visual cues	58
Figure 77- Interfaces	59
Figure 78-Security measures	59
Figure 79-Real-time prediction flow	59
Figure 80-Gantt Chart	66
Figure 81-Class Diagram for MediVision-AI	67

1. Introduction

As a common disease of women all around the world, breast cancer is considered one of the leading causes of mortality (Wilkinson and Gathani, 2022). This section discusses the role of deep learning in breast cancer prevalence and detection of tumours (benign and malignant) while identifying challenges and limitations to accurate detection and segmentation. It outlines research goals of developing a Hybrid CNN-Transformer model for efficient results.

1.1 Background

Breast cancer is one of the most widespread cancers (Figure 1), that must be detected early and accurately to increase the survival rates. Mammography and ultrasound imaging are crucial traditional diagnostic methods for breast cancer recognition, although these techniques often show limitations, including poor contrast, operator dependency, and overlapping tissue structures that affect accuracy (Bunnell, 2023). Conventional approaches, like manual image interpretation still depend on radiologist expertise, making them prone to diagnostic variability and human errors.

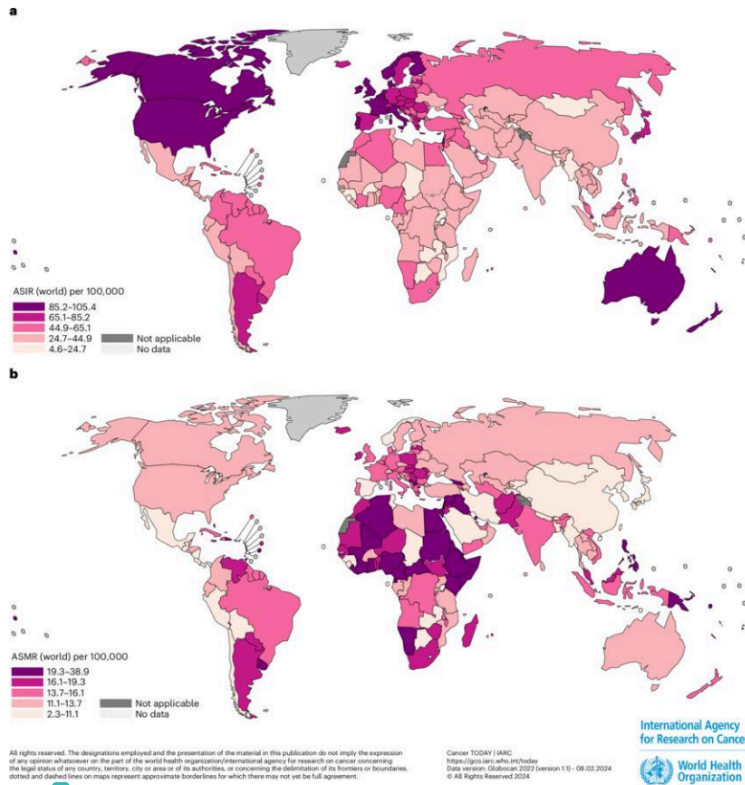


Figure 1-Map of the global-wide female breast cancer cases in 2022 Estimated age-standardized rates of incidence (a) and mortality (b) (Kim et al., 2025)

Emergence of Convolutional Neural Networks and Vision Transformers has become a most efficient finding for breast cancer detection and segmentation using ultrasound images. According to recent studies (Figure 2), CNNs are highly functional towards extracting spatial features from medical images while Transformers recognize long-range dependencies to enhance classification accuracy (Karimzadeh, 2023). Fusion of these two architectures has illustrated notable advancements in medical image inspection, allowing a more reliable and automated detection methods.

This research suggests a Hybrid CNN-Transformer model to strengthen both techniques, improving global spatial understanding and feature extraction. Moreover, the research expects to address the limitations of conventional methods with leveraging deep learning advancements to contribute to an accurate, efficient, and interpretable AI-based breast cancer detection system. The end-result of this approach is a full-stack AI-powered diagnostic platform (MediVision-AI) which connects the gap between research and real-world clinical use.

1.1 Problem Statement and Objectives

Breast cancer, a prevalent health concern which evolve from the cells of breast has fuelled progress in the recognition and treatment thanks to advancements, coupled with earlier detection, innovative treatment options, and a more comprehensive understanding regarding the disease. This section highlights the research problem and key objectives, for implementing a Hybrid CNN-Transformer algorithm to strengthen segmentation efficiency, detection accuracy, and explain-ability while overcoming challenges such as noise, low contrast, and misclassification.

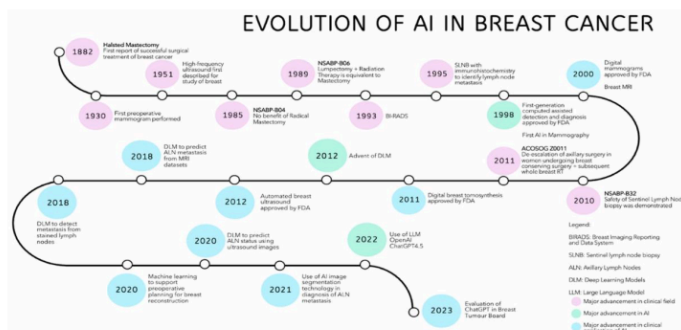


Figure 2-Evolution of AI applications on breast cancer care (Chia and G. S., 2025)

1.1.1 Problem Statement

As a significant cause of mortality within women global wide, implementing an early and accurate breast cancer detection is crucial for enhancing survival rate (Ginsburg et al., 2020). Due to its non-invasive nature and effectiveness, ultrasound imaging is widely used for breast cancer screening to find tumours in dense breast tissue. Yet, conventional diagnosis using ultrasound displays speckle noise, operator dependency, and low contrast which influence consistencies and diagnosis

in evaluation (Bunnell, 2023). In addition, systems based on handcrafted features (e.g.: CAD) find difficult to attain high accuracy due to the variability and complexity of breast disfigurement in ultrasound images (Karimzadeh, 2023).

Recent advancements like, CNNs and ViTs have exhibited favourable outcomes in medical image analysis while allowing automated tumour classification and segmentation. CNNs are essential when it comes to extracting spatial features although it has limitations in obtaining long-range dependencies and Transformers are expertise in learning global contextual relationships although it demands large amounts of data for training (Chia and Seng, 2025).

Furthermore, the lack of model explain-ability is another crucial challenge, which avoids clinical adoption. It is difficult for medical professionals to interpret AI-based predictions, since many deep learning models operate as "black boxes". Explain-ability techniques (e.g.: Grad-CAM and Transformer Attention Maps) are require developing trust while improving the interpretability of AI-driven diagnostics (Karimzadeh, 2023). Moreover, model generalizability can be affected by dataset partiality, leading to imbalances in diagnostic accuracy over individual demographic varieties (Alruily and Malapati, 2024).

Therefore, to bridge these demands and to have a more robust breast cancer detection and segmentation, this research propose a hybrid approach combining CNNs and Transformers is necessary to leverage their complementary strengths. The study also ensures fulfilment of HIPAA and GDPR regulations for ethical AI deployment in healthcare applications (Al-Okaily, 2020).

1.1.2 Objectives

Breast cancer remains a critical health issue where resources for early screening, diagnosis, and treatment are often limited. This research has a few crucial objectives when it comes to deep learning recognition models and improving diagnostic accuracy, optimize feature selection, and integrate advanced techniques.

First objective is to implement a hybrid DL model with CNN-based feature extraction and Transformer-based spatial analysis. CNNs are beneficial to capture general image features (e.g.: edges and textures). Transformers, on the other hand, offer a generalised contextual understanding by improving self-attention mechanisms. With the hybrid approach, the research aims to enhance both classification and segmentation accuracy in breast ultrasound images (Ferreira, 2023).

Next, the Experimental Research methodology will be utilized to evaluate the strength of the proposed model. This method involves with training and testing the developed model on publicly available datasets while performance assessment evaluated by key metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. This precise evaluation helps in determining the model generalizability and reliability in medical imaging applications (Hossain & Kumar, 2023).

Then, a comparable analysis will be directed to compare segmentation results with benchmark models (e.g.: ResNet and ViT). The objectives are to exhibit a superior segmentation accuracy and efficiency as the models widely used in medical image segmentation which will provide a strong baseline for assessing the performance of the proposed hybrid system (Madhu & Malapati, 2024).

Furthermore, to enhance model explain-ability, this research utilizes techniques like Transformer attention visualization and Grad-CAM. With the implementation of interpretable tools like these, this research expects to justify every prediction to prove transparency and adopt to clinical practices (Karimzadeh, 2023).

To avoid disparities between research and practical application, real-world applicability and clinical feasibility of the model will be analysed. Radiologist assessments and experimental validation will be used on AI system to refine the model for better integration according to healthcare setting (Chia & Seng, 2025).

Another pivotal outcome is a full-stack software platform development with a web-based system and AI model integration. With this platform, medical professionals will upload ultrasound images and receive AI-driven diagnostic insights in real time, improving efficiency in clinical settings (Olawade and C.-O., 2025).

Lastly, the platform will be developed using Python for backend processing, while Vue.js acts as the frontend visualization. As for the database management, the system will utilize with MySQL. These tech-stacks will offer a real-time, scalable, and user-friendly interface for medical professionals to ultrasound medical imaging analysis and to get automated classification and segmentation results (Sharma, 2024).

2 Literature Review

Breast cancer remains one of the most significant health challenges for women while several studies have been conducted covering image augmentation for medical imaging, particularly when deploying deep learning (DL) models for breast cancer detection. This section dives into existing studies on breast cancer detection and segmentation that has advanced deep learning models, hybrid CNN-Transformer architectures, and challenges in the sector. The foundation of the proposed hybrid deep learning model focused on analysing and improving state-of-the-art approaches for breast cancer diagnosis using ultrasound imaging.

2.1 Breast Cancer Detection & Segmentation in Medical Imaging

Traditionally, several imaging modalities, like mammography, magnetic resonance imaging (MRI), and ultrasound (US), are used in breast cancer detection. Mammography is the most used as a screening technique, although it demands high-energy X-rays. Use of high-energy X-rays can cause side-effects over time, and the quality of these images may be affected by breast density, making it difficult to recognise cases like malignancies (Amit Kumar, 2024, Karimzadeh, 2023). MRI is another imaging technique when it comes to breast cancer detection with high sensitivity. Expensive costs, demand for contrast agents, and time consumption are the major factors that make MRIs not suitable for all patients (Ranisaha, 2024). On the other hand, ultrasound imaging is cost-effective, radiation-free,

and widely accessible, which makes it an eligible selection for breast cancer detection in countries with limited access to mammography (Chia and G. S., 2025, Omar, 2022).

Ultrasound imaging has become a beneficial modality for women with dense breast tissue where mammography may be less effective during screening and diagnosis process. It uses high-frequency sound waves in order to identify tumours, cysts, and lesions by creating real-time images of breast tissue (Karimzadeh, 2023, Bunnell and P. S., 2023). As an efficient complementary diagnostic tool, ultrasound technique does not obscure lesions, like in mammography (Bunnell and P. S., 2023). Ultrasound images often depend on handler while subject to inter-observer variability that can influence diagnostic accuracy (Ranisaha, 2024). To avoid this, computer-aided diagnosis (CAD) systems have been developed using machine learning (ML) and deep learning (DL) models to help radiologists in analysing ultrasound images more precisely (Karimzadeh, 2023).

Even though ultrasound technique is an effective high-powered component for cancer detection, its ability often bounded by low resolution, poor image contrast, and blurred tumours edges caused by speckle artifacts, noise, and acoustic shadowing (Ranisaha, 2024). These drawbacks make physical interpretation challenging and it leads to high false-positive rates and undesirable biopsies (Bunnell and P. S., 2023). Moreover, the accuracy of ultrasound imaging relies on the skill and experience of the operator which makes it less standardized over various clinical surroundings (Ranisaha, 2024, Omar, 2022). To deflect these drawbacks, DL-based CAD systems have improved to adopt to enhance tumour classification and segmentation. These models can evaluate ultrasound images to detect malignancies and provide assistance in decision making to radiologists while enhancing the ability of early breast cancer diagnosis (Karimzadeh, 2023).

2.2 Deep Learning in Medical Image Analysis

CNNs (in deep learning) have changed medical image classification by enhancing detection accuracy and allowing automated feature extraction. It is a common practice to use CNNs for breast cancer detection that helps classify tumours as benign or malignant based on imaging modalities including mammography, MRI, and ultrasound (Amit Kumar, 2024). CNNs exclude the demand of manual feature engineering, having them study hierarchical patterns clearly from raw data (Omar, 2022). These models often need large datasets to avoid overfitting despite their effectiveness, and dependence on black-box decision making deepens interpretability and clinical trust concerns (Tuan, 2024). Data augmentation techniques such as Neural Style Transfer (NST) and Generative Adversarial Networks (GANs) have been initiated to improve the execution of CNNs in breast cancer classification while maintaining crucial tumour attributes, reducing arguments regarding privacy constraints and limited annotated data (Ranisaha, 2024). Additionally, to support radiologists in tumour localisation and delineation, CNN-based segmentation models have been implemented to provide a comprehensive diagnostic solution (Omar, 2022).

Although CNNs are experts in capturing local spatial patterns, they often find it difficult to model long-range dependencies in medical images. ViTs have the ability to avoid these complications with self-attention mechanisms to examine the full image promptly while making them extremely functional towards complex medical imaging tasks like feature

extraction and tumour segmentation (Noman et al., 2025). ViTs effectively weigh various parts of an image to capture more contextual information relevant to diagnosis, unlike CNNs and their dependence on fixed-sized convolutional filters (Ranisaha, 2024). Furthermore, ViTs present strong performance in recognising subtle tumour characteristics, which may be the reason behind the rise of adoption in breast cancer detection and segmentation (Noman et al., 2025). Nevertheless, ViTs demand a large number of labelled data for training and are computationally expensive, which limits widespread application in clinical settings (Ranisaha, 2024). Researchers have done over hybrid architectures to combine strengths of CNNs with ViTs to address limitations while achieving higher accuracy and efficiency (Omar, 2022).

Integrating CNNs and ViTs as hybrid models has been illustrated as an effective way to improve breast cancer detection and segmentation. These models are furnished with a comprehensive and accurate analysis of medical images as they accommodate CNNs for local feature extraction and ViTs for global contextual understanding (Ranisaha, 2024, Noman et al., 2025). Replacing radiologists with computer-aided diagnosis (CAD) systems, CNN-Transformer hybrids have been particularly helpful to automate both lesion localisation and classification (Omar, 2022). Hybrid models are known for their ability to improve explainability in deep learning-based medical diagnostics. Hybrid algorithms integrate with Explainable AI (XAI) techniques, including attention maps and saliency-based visualisation, providing greater transparency in model decision-making, while traditional CNN models function as black-box classifiers (Ranisaha, 2024). These models empower radiologists to better interpret AI-generated predictions as they enhance clinical adoption and trust.

All in all, CNNs and Transformers integration has led to more accurate, efficient, and interpretable breast cancer detection systems with medical imaging. Lightweight transformer architectures, data-efficient ViT training, and multimodal fusion techniques are significant future advancements for further improvement of AI-driven medical diagnosis and segmentation capabilities (Noman et al., 2025).

2.3 Related Works

Breast cancer segmentation is widely applied as a part of boundary delineation and tumour localisation for radiologists to make accurate decisions. U-Net, Mask R-CNN, and UCapsNet are several deep learning-based segmentation architectures that offer distinctive advantages. One of the most widely passed down architectures is U-Net, as it has exhibited a high accuracy in breast ultrasound image segmentation with its encoder-decoder structure and skip connections that enable precise segmentation of tumour regions (Omar, 2022). In spite of that, U-Net models are likely to conflict with poor-quality ultrasound images and small lesion detection (Madhu et al., 2024). To avoid these objections, a hybrid model integrating U-Net and Capsule Networks was suggested. This model improves segmentation by maintaining spatial hierarchies for more efficient finding of various tumour shapes and orientations (Madhu et al., 2024).

Moreover, another research has discovered Mask R-CNN for breast tumour segmentation through multimodal medical imaging applications. Compared to U-Net, Mask R-CNN applies instance segmentation, allowing more correct tumour region identification in heterogeneous ultrasound images (Atrey, Singh, and Bodhey, 2024). When

it comes to downsides, Mask R-CNN models are computationally expensive and demand large, annotated datasets for better performance (Madhu et al., 2024).

Attention-based deep learning models are recent advancements that have noticeably enhanced the accuracy of breast tumour segmentation. This mechanism focuses on medically relevant regions by mitigating false positives to improve boundary refinement. As an example, dual attention mechanisms combining spatial and channel attention have been employed to optimise feature extraction for breast ultrasound segmentation tasks. These models support deep learning algorithms to effectively adjust their focus according to exact tumour regions (Devi et al., 2025). In addition, these models can highlight critical areas of interest by incorporating lesion attention blocks within ultrasound images in order to make more accurate tumour segmentation (Devi et al., 2025). Besides, these self-supervised models used transformer-based attention methods that illustrated better performance in breast cancer segmentation.

A study by Zhai et al. (2022) suggested a dual-generator framework that implements segmentation masks without needing labelled datasets, presenting its strength in handling unlabelled ultrasound images (Devi et al., 2025). Further, ViTs fine-tuning techniques have revealed promising results in improving segmentation accuracy by refining generalisation over various datasets (Alruily et al., 2024).

Explainability in medical AI has become a crucial point due to the advancement of complex deep learning models. To understand segmentation results and improve the clinical trustworthiness of AI models, Grad-CAM and SHAP have widely been adopted. Grad-CAM creates visual heatmaps to understand which regions offer the most to the model's segmentation decision (Ragab et al., 2022). Identifying misclassified tumour regions is easier with this technique as it makes sure that deep learning models align with interpretations of radiologists (Chowa et al., 2023). As for SHAP, it offers a satisfying granular explanation for feature importance that is essential for recognising critical tumour characteristics influencing segmentation results (Chowa et al., 2023). Use of explainable AI methods on deep learning-based segmentation models enhances reliability, interpretability, and clinical adoption of dynamic breast cancer recognition systems (Ragab et al., 2022, Chowa et al., 2023). Further studies will aim to upgrade attention-based segmentation models to ensure interpretability through advanced explainability frameworks.

2.4 Hybrid CNN-Transformer Models in Medical Imaging

Hybrid deep learning models (combined CNNs and ViTs) have obtained a remarkable consideration in medical imaging with the effect of improved local and global feature extraction mechanisms. CNNs have a high ability to capture fine-grained spatial patterns while Transformers utilise self-attention mechanisms for model's long-range dependencies which is efficient for medical image classification and segmentation (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024). Lack of interpretability and complications with complex spatial relationships are the significant defects of traditional CNN-based models that could avoid using hybrid CNN models. Hybrid CNNs are following a method of extracting features at multiple scales while enhancing explain-ability to eliminate the limitations (Karimzadeh,

2023). By combining the capabilities of CNNs and Transformers, hybrid models improve both classification accuracy and model robustness for breast cancer diagnosis (Devi et al., 2025).

To bring out of low-level spatial features like, textures, edges, and tumour shapes from ultrasounds, CNNs applying convolutional filters and then hand over to deep convolutional layers to find out complex structures in breast tissue (Devi et al., 2025). But CNNs are struggling to gather global contextual information in an entire image due to the limited receptive fields. On contrary, Transformers use self-attention mechanisms for image processing in order to observe relationships between distant pixels across an image. ViTs identify patterns in tumour growth, differentiate between benign and malignant tissues, while improving segmentation accuracy by enabling these procedures (Karimzadeh, 2023). Hybrid models retain the abilities of both architectures as they are combined with CNNs and it makes them appropriate for complex tasks like breast cancer classification and segmentation (Devi et al., 2025).

There are few studies that have presented the supremacy of CNN-Transformer hybrid models over individual CNNs or Transformers in breast cancer imaging. For an instance, the BCDNet model combined with VGG16's feature extraction-attention mechanism, reached a 94.5% classification accuracy, outperforming MobileNet (91.3%), IDCNN (89.6%), and DTCN (88.2%) (Devi et al., 2025). The effectiveness of hybrid deep learning models can be highlighted by optimizing feature representation for medical diagnosis. To explain further, hybrid machine learning models like SVMs have shown significant improvements in a study that compares hybrid SVM-based models with standalone deep learning classifiers have found, IQI-BGWO-SVM technique outperformed conventional classification methods on the Mammographic Image Analysis Society (MIAS) dataset (Chia and G. S., 2025). The results further explaining the integration of different AI techniques improves medical image analysis. Moreover, CRO+XGBoost hybrid model have achieved notable outcomes with 99.12% accuracy over traditional deep learning models using BC-UCI dataset (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024). These results have shown the significance of hybrid approaches with combined multiple AI techniques for the betterment of breast cancer detection. All in all, the use of CNN-Transformer hybrid models offers a promising direction to enhance breast cancer classification and segmentation. Therefore, future studies are encouraged to aim optimizing these architectures to operate as real-time clinical applications that maintain explain-ability while fusion between multi-modal medical data for comprehensive analysis (Karimzadeh, 2023).

2.5 Challenges & Gaps in Existing Research

Although CNNs have gained success in medical imaging, their efficiency is still limited by several challenges. One of the most discussed issues in studies is the difficulty in distinguishing benign from malignant tumours (Amit Kumar, 2024). CNN-based algorithms often find it difficult with generalization due to the small and imbalanced datasets. When these kinds of datasets used for training, leading to overfitting and poor real-world performance (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024). Also, to avoid overfitting, and improper tuning can degrade model accuracy, CNNs follows a careful procedure of weight optimization (Devi et al., 2025). The lack of transparency and interpretability is another challenge that makes less suitable CNN-only models for clinical decision-making. Due to the lack of understanding and the knowledge (theory based on a model's predictions), many radiologists and clinicians still hesitant to rely on AI-driven computer-aided diagnosis (CAD) system (Karimzadeh, 2023). To overcome these, CNNs are utilised to integrate with interpretable architectures as Capsule Networks, although it's with computational complexity (Madhu et al., 2024).

When it comes to ViTs, although it has shown a promising efficiency in medical image classification and segmentation, it also come with significant challenges. As transformers require large datasets for effective training, one of the biggest obstacles is data scarcity. It is difficult to fully leverage the power of self-attention mechanisms when most breast cancer datasets are small and unbalanced (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024). Another limitation is the high computational cost, as training and deploying transformer-based models require powerful GPUs and extensive memory resources which makes less feasible for real-time clinical applications (Olawade et al., 2025). Transformers often struggle with managing noisy and unstandardized medical images especially in breast ultrasound (BUS) datasets as it varies with image quality due to operator dependence (Omar, 2022). Additional preprocessing steps required to be followed for feature extraction since ViTs alone may not be sufficient for breast cancer detection (Devi et al., 2025). The lack of standardized evaluation metrics is another crucial challenge which have made difficult to compare transformer-based models and establish benchmarks for medical imaging performance across different studies (Chia and G. S., 2025).

To overcome restrains within standalone CNNs and Transformers, there is a raising demand for hybrid deep learning models to bring out the strengths of both architectures. Hybrid models have shown higher performance by influencing CNNs for local feature extraction and Transformers for global context modelling (Madhu et al., 2024). To illustrate, ResNet with Mask R-CNN have retained higher classification precision contrast to conventional CNNs alone in studies (Madhu et al., 2024). It is demonstrating the potentiality of multi-stage deep learning architectures. Moreover, without proper transparent decision-making processes, explainability remains a major concern in AI-driven breast cancer detection. Without explainability, clinicians may be unwilling to adopt AI tools in their decision-making process. Recent advancements such as SHAP and Grad-CAM have assisted this negativity by offering visual and quantitative explanations of model predictions (Karimzadeh, 2023). With these techniques, hybrid models could enhance clinical trust and adoption of AI in breast cancer diagnosis.

All in all, developing interpretable, computationally efficient hybrid models that can generalize well across diverse and unbalanced datasets should be a part of future research to generalize hybrid models well across diverse and unbalanced datasets. It is essential to collaborate AI researchers with medical professionals to ensure that AI-driven breast cancer detection tools are both clinically relevant, practically deployable and approved for real-world healthcare settings (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024, Chia and G. S., 2025).

2.6 Summary & Research Justification

Key Findings

The review of literature highlights that through deep learning techniques, breast cancer detection and segmentation has shown a significant advancement. Ultrasound imaging is the cost-effective and radiation-free alternative for breast cancer diagnosis among other traditional methods such as, mammography, and MRI (Amit Kumar, 2024, Chia and G. S., 2025). However, due to noise, low contrast, and operator variability, manual interpretation of ultrasound images is challenging as it leads to high false-positive rate (Ranisaha, 2024).

Deep learning-based (CNNs) have proven effectiveness in feature extraction and classification of breast cancer images. However, standalone CNNs face difficulties while capturing global contextual information and usually demands large datasets to generalize effectively (Omar,

2022, Devi et al., 2025). When it comes to ViTs, they're expertise to capture long-range dependencies but requires extensive computational resources. However, ViTs suffer from data scarcity issues (Olawade et al., 2025).

Particularly CNN-Transformer architectures (in hybrid deep learning models) have been suggested as an effectual infusion, as they combine local feature extraction power of CNNs with the global attention mechanisms of Transformers (Madhu et al., 2024). These hybrid models exhibit improved feature representation, enhanced accuracy, and greater interpretability while making them well-suited for clinical applications.

Justification for a Hybrid CNN-Transformer Approach

According to the limitations of CNNs and Transformers mentioned above, it is essential to have a hybrid approach in order to improve the accuracy of breast cancer classification and segmentation. When CNNs efficiently gather spatial features like, tumour textures, boundaries, and shapes, Transformers have the ability to analyse broader contextual patterns within ultrasound images (Islam, Islam, and Majumder, 2024). This fusion mitigates the drawbacks of small medical datasets using CNNs that can pre-train on large-scale datasets and with Transformers that can focus on refining feature relationships (Chia and G. S., 2025).

When it comes to explain-ability in AI adoption in healthcare, it is a key factor that can enhance by integrating Grad-CAM and SHAP techniques to build-up clinical trust, allowing radiologists to visually interpret AI predictions and validate segmentation accuracy (Karimzadeh, 2023, Alrubaie, Aljobouri, and Aljobawi, 2023).

As for selecting a pre-trained model obtain better outcome as a part of hybrid model was done according to a comparative analysis of several state-of-the-art DL networks for breast lesion classification (Ferreira, 2023). According to the evaluation (Figure 3), InceptionV3, ResNet, DenseNet, MobileNetV2, EfficientNet was selected while GoogLeNet reduced as InceptionV3 is an improved version of it.

Networks	Year	Description
GoogLeNet [61]	2014	22 layers deep network with Inception modules.
InceptionV3 [63]	2016	Improved version of GoogLeNet with 48 layers.
ResNet [65]	2016	Deep CNN with residual blocks, that fast-forward the activation of a layer to a deeper layer in the network.
DenseNet [66]	2017	Deep CNN with dense blocks, that connect any two layers in a feed-forward fashion.
MobileNetV2 [67]	2018	53 layers deep CNN with inverted residual blocks with bottle-necking features.
EfficientNet [68]	2020	CNN inspired by MobileNetV2, fine-tuned for obtaining high accuracy with low computational effort.

Figure 3-Model Evaluation

Addressing Existing Gaps and Contributes to the Field

This study ¹⁵veys the identified crucial gaps in prior research by suggesting a hybrid deep learning model that integrate Convolutional Neural ¹⁶stworks (CNNs) with Vision Transformers (ViTs). The structural coordination utilises the interrelated strengths of CNNs in evoking local spatial features and ViTs in background awareness and modeling long-range dependencies. In addition, the proposed model display higher-level of ability in gathering both broader anatomical context and detailed textures that is particular for subtle lesion feature recognition using ultrasound breast cancer images (Sharafaddini et al., 2024).

Segmentation and classification accuracy is considerably escalated by coordinating Transformer-based global circumstances evaluating with CNN-based spatial feature extraction before final classification. Transformers provide a wider contextual understanding of tissue anatomy whilst CNNs exceed at obtaining local features. This two-sided results in better and accurate depiction of lesion boundaries, exceptionally in complicated ultrasound images (Devi et al., 2025; Madhu et al., 2024). Contrast to CNN-only or Transformer-only models, the hybrid framework captures higher segmentation execution due to interrelated feature learning (Kim et al., 2025).

Furthermore, this research manages transfer learning techniques that occupied to **handle the data scarcity challenge** frequently found in medical imaging. Supporting ³²er model converge and better generalization, both backbone networks are computed with pretrained weights from large-scale datasets (e.g., ImageNet) with fewer labeled ultrasound images. Transfer learning not only reduces overfitting but also maintains strong performance metrics as it enabling robust model generalisation even under constrained dataset availability (Bukke et al., 2024). This scheme coordinates with current studies underlining the use of transfer learning to overcome annotation bottlenecks (Zhuang et al., 2021).

The model interpretability includes explainable AI (XAI) techniques like such as Class Activation Mapping (CAM) and attention visualisation, although the current training code not explicitly shown. Components like these **offer transparency to model's decision-making** that allows clinicians to validate predictions relying on highlighted image regions. This guarantees clinically aligned decisions through AI system support by increasing the trust and adoption of AI in diagnostic workflows (Karimzadeh, 2023). In the future, the work covers incorporating XAI tools like Grad-CAM for CNN components and attention rollout for the Transformer stream (Fantozzi & Naldi, 2024).

Moreover, Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) is engaged in enhancing local contrast to improve preprocessing in ultrasound images. The use of this method is to highlight lesion boundaries and improve feature visibility in low-contrast settings (Mishra, 2021). The dataset is synthetically expanded and diversified integrating with robust augmentations using the Albumentations library including motion blur, elastic deformation, noise addition, and brightness adjustments to advance model generalization under real-world variations (Cossio, 2023).

The final model outcome was determined using a carefully balanced dataset that each class (normal, benign, malignant) is fairly represented by strategic oversampling. This is to avoid biased learning and ensure fairness in training as it known limitation in many diagnostic

AI studies due to class imbalance (Aubaidan et al., 2024). Stratified sampling separates validation and test sets while model accuracy is continuously assessed through confusion matrices and performance metrics.

Strategically **balancing the extent of CNN layers with the complexity of Transformer components** by computational efficiency while it reached by deploying a weight-optimised hybrid model. This decreases irrelevant operational costs while preserving accuracy, making the system attainable for real-time processing and deployment using low-resource clinical settings (Omar, 2022). Further advancement of scalability across varied hardware environments achieved by inference-time optimisations and model compression.

By **merging strong diagnostic performance with a deployment-ready architecture**, proposed model narrow-down the space between practical usability and high-accuracy AI systems. Segmentation precision reduces dependence on large, labelled datasets, and ensures decisions by increasing explain-ability and resource-efficiency (Shen et al., 2023). This comprehensive method requires the system highly adaptable and versatile for real-world healthcare integration, specifically in early breast cancer detection scenarios where precision and speed are more analytical.

All in all, the growing body of this research recommend hybrid deep learning models in medical imaging by providing a scalable, interpretable, and data-efficient solution tailored to breast cancer detection. The proposed structure not only provides a high classification accuracy but also addresses clinical usability through model transparency and adaptability that makes a practical candidate for integration into real-world diagnostic systems (Singh et al., 2023).

3 Research Design

As a global problem, breast cancer requires knowledge and early detection to speed-up effective cancer treatment. This section introduces the process of research design for development of Hybrid CNN-Transformer Approach for Breast Cancer Detection and Segmentation. The research proceeds following Experimental Research methodology for model evaluation and a Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) technique for full-stack platform implementation. The section will convey system architecture, optimization strategies, and integration into a Django-Vue.js Web platform.

The interdisciplinary nature of this study integrates:

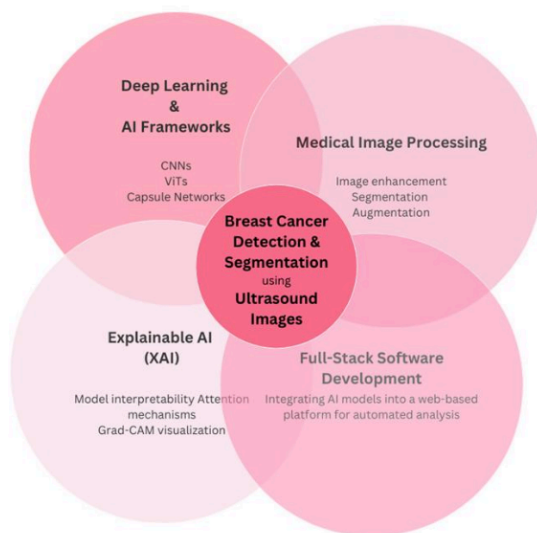


Figure 4-Venn diagram

Based on the Venn Diagram (Figure 4) of research areas, the study explores the intersection of deep learning, medical image processing, explainable artificial intelligence (XAI), and full-stack software development in the context of breast cancer detection using ultrasound imaging.

Deep Learning & AI Frameworks

The study explores the intersection of deep learning, medical image processing, explainable artificial intelligence (XAI), and full-stack software development in the context of breast cancer detection using ultrasound imaging. As the central focus, development and evaluation of a hybrid Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) and Transformer model is intended in order to enhance diagnostic accuracy and segmentation performance.

According to a study by Oliveira et al. (2023) recommend that hybrid deep learning models can outperform standalone approaches in terms of classification accuracy by integrating multiple architectures together. Therefore, the study **investigates whether the CNN-Transformer hybrid model offers worthier performance** in detecting breast cancer lesions. It **inspects the assistance of attention mechanisms** built-in Transformer networks to the advancement of lesion segmentation while **precisely compares the hybrid model's performance against conventional CNN and Transformer-only architectures**.

When it comes to medical image processing, the study highlights **the importance of data preprocessing and augmentation techniques in improving model strength**. The research aims to discover **how techniques like, image rotation, flipping, and scaling can raise model's adaptability to ultrasound image variability** by citing Aggarwal et al. (2024), who highlight the transformative impact of augmentation strategies on model effectiveness. Moreover, it **explores the benefit of contrast enhancement in lesion boundary clarification and the contribution of noise reduction methods** to greater diagnostic accuracy. The overall performance of the detection and segmentation model achieved using these techniques that are systematically applied and validated to assess their influence.

The research also **emphasizes the interpretability of AI models** since **transparency** is crucial in clinical contexts for trust and adoption. The implementation process includes **explainable AI techniques** such as **Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping (Grad-CAM)** and Transformer attention visualization to deliver a more transparent decision-making process to medical professionals. According to the finding of Sureshkumar et al. (2024), these **techniques enhance the interpretability of forecast, enabling clinicians' rationale acknowledgment** behind the model outputs. Also, the research dives through a critical review that **examines the trade-offs between accuracy and explainability to evaluate predictive performance vs. model transparency** and understand how to strike a precise optimal balance for clinical applications.

By diving deep into algorithmic development, the research identifies the **significance of an AI model integration with more secure, scalable, and user-friendly diagnostic system**. When it comes to the recommendations from Fanizzi et al. (2024), this research **defines the design of a full-stack web-based platform which facilitates visualization and real-time image analysis** for clinical use. Moreover, it **executes cybersecurity measures, such as, secure login protocols and data transmission to secure integrity and the confidentiality of sensitive medical data**. The system architecture **also** capable of real-time prediction while providing immediate feedback to users through a responsive and intuitive interface.

In general, the research questions are aligned according to the utilised methodologies while supporting to reach final outcome of promoting practical AI adoption in the field of medical imaging. The study presents a thorough approach to advance breast cancer diagnostics with technology. This research is based on a comprehensive methodology and one of technical innovations for clinical utilisation with enhanced user experience and security to address key challenges in the deployment of AI in healthcare environments.

3.1 Hybrid CNN-Transformer Model

The system utilizes a hybrid deep learning model that co-opting CNNs for spatial feature extraction with Vision Transformers (ViTs) for global context learning.

The architecture structured as (Figure 5),

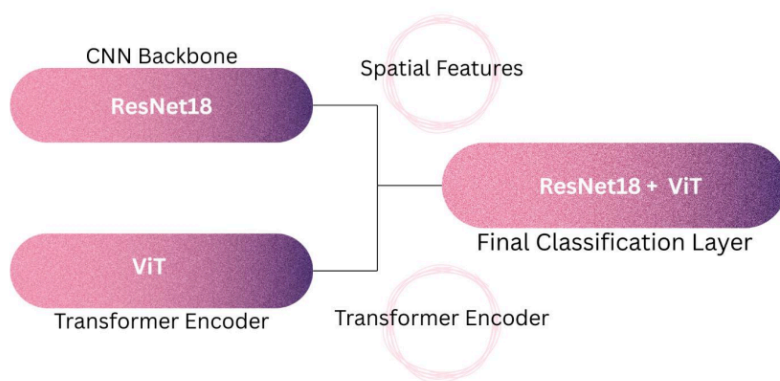


Figure 5-Hybrid Architecture

CNN Backbone will extract spatial features from the input image and use a pre-trained model ResNet18. After feature extraction from CNN, output can be pass through a **Transformer Encoder** to capture global dependencies. After processing the combined features from both CNN and Transformer, a Fully Connected (FC) layer will classify the image into its respective class.

3.2 Data Preprocessing Pipeline

Preprocessing appreciably affects classification accuracy (Aggarwal et al., 2024). Crucial phases include (Figure 6):

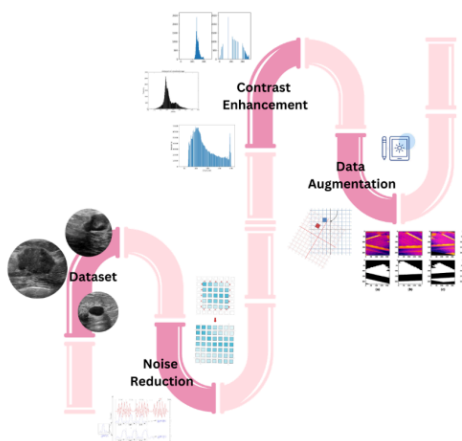


Figure 6-Data Processing Pipeline

The dataset (Figure 7) utilised for the research is a publicly available **Breast Ultrasound Dataset (BUD)** from Kaggle (Al-Dhabyani et al., 2020). As the next step, noise reduction was performed using median filtering and wavelet transform. Then, contrast enhancement was achieved by histogram through equalization. Lastly, random rotations, flips, and adaptive brightness adjustments were applied as part of data augmentation.

NO	DESCRIPTION	REMARKS
1	Data Source URL	https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/aryashah2k/breast-ultrasound-images-dataset/data
2	Image Size	Average 500 * 500 pixels
3	Data License	CC0: Public Domain
4	Year	2018
5	Usability	10.0
6	No of Patients	600
7	No of Images	1600+
8	Data Description	Contains ultrasound images labelled as benign , malignant , and normal cases.

Figure 7-Dataset

3.3 Full-Stack Platform Design

It is important for a real-world application to have a secure and scalable platform (Sureshkumar et al., 2024). The platform (Figure 8) includes a frontend built with Vue.js for user-friendly interaction, backend with Django powered by AI model integration and a MySQL database to store patient ultrasound images and analysis history. Further, the platform integrates with security measures like HIPAA-compliant encryption and GDPR-compliant for data handling (Fanizzi et al., 2024).

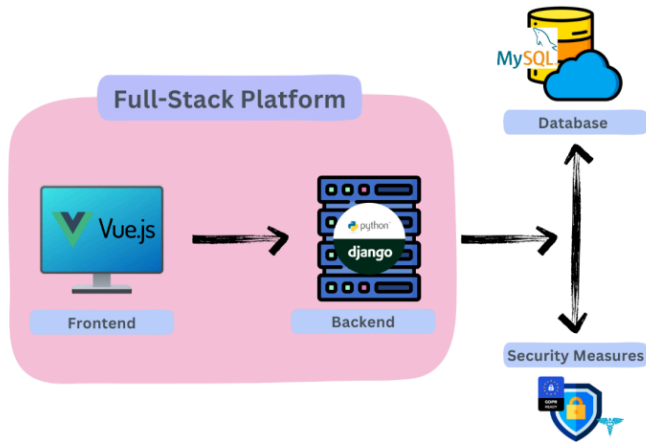


Figure 8-Web Platform

3.4 UML Diagrams

User Stories

Story 1: Secure Authentication for Physicians (Figure 9)

Mark: "Secure Authentication for Physicians"

As a physician, I want to securely log into the system using my credentials,
So that I can access the diagnostic tools and patient data without unauthorized access.

Acceptance Criteria:

- The physician can enter an email and password to log in.
- If credentials are correct, access is granted to the dashboard.
- If credentials are incorrect, an error message is displayed.
- A password reset option is available for forgotten credentials.

Figure 9-Userstory 1

Story 2: Upload and Analyse Ultrasound Images (Figure 10)

William: "Upload and Analyse Ultrasound Images"

As a physician, I want to upload ultrasound images for AI-based analysis,

So that I can receive an accurate diagnosis and confidence score for better decision-making.

Acceptance Criteria:

- The physician can upload an ultrasound image in supported formats (e.g., PNG, JPG).
- The system processes the image and applies necessary pre-processing steps.
- The AI model analyses the image and classifies it as benign or malignant.
- The system displays the results with confidence levels.
- If an invalid file format is uploaded, an error message is shown.

Figure 10-Userstory 2

Story 3: Monitor Diahnosis Trends and Performance

Susan: "Monitor Diagnosis Trends and Performance"

As a physician, I want to view analytics and trends of past diagnoses,

So that I can track patient case trends and improve diagnostic accuracy.

Acceptance Criteria:

- The physician can access an analytics dashboard.
- The dashboard displays historical diagnosis results and accuracy rates.
- Filtering options are available (date range, case type, and etc).
- Graphs and charts visualize trends, such as benign vs. malignant percentages.
- If no data is available, the system prompts the physician to upload images.

Figure 11-Userstory 3

Use Case Diagram

Use case diagram of MediVision-AI web platform (Figure 12).

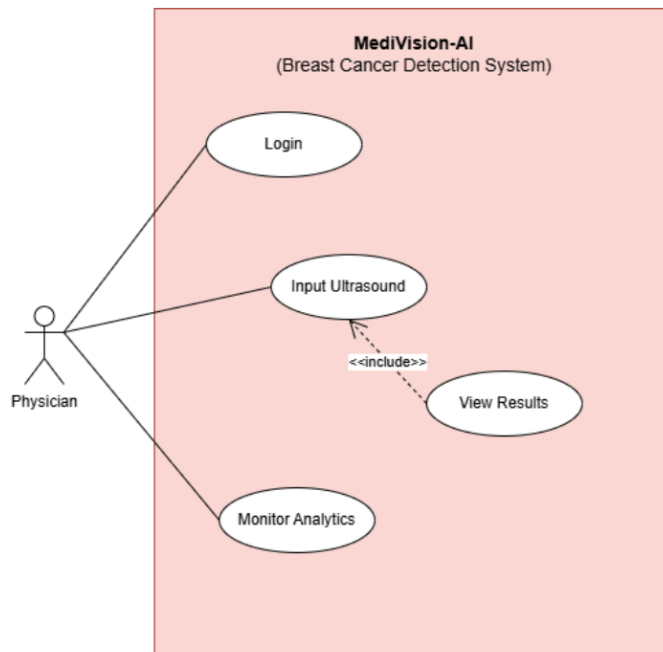


Figure 12-Usecase Diagram

Use Case Descriptions

1. User login (Figure 13)

1. Use Case: Login to the System

Actor(s): Physician

Description: The physician logs into the system to access its functionalities.

Preconditions: The physician must have a registered account.

Postconditions: The physician is successfully authenticated and redirected to the dashboard.

Main Flow:

1. The physician enters their email and password.
2. The system verifies the credentials.
3. If valid, the system grants access and redirects to the dashboard.
4. If invalid, the system displays an error message.

Alternate Flow:

- If the physician forgets their password, they can reset it using the "Forgot Password" option.

Figure 13-Description 1

2. Input Ultrasound Images and Get Results (Figure 14)

2. Use Case: Input Ultrasound Images and Get Results

Actor(s): Physician

Description: The physician uploads ultrasound images for analysis by the AI model.

Preconditions: The physician must be logged into the system.

Postconditions: The system processes the image and provides a diagnostic result.

Main Flow:

1. The physician selects and uploads an ultrasound image.
2. The system preprocesses the image (resizing, normalization).
3. The AI model analyses the image and generates a classification result (e.g., benign, malignant, or normal).
4. The system displays the result with a confidence score.

Alternate Flow:

- If the image format is incorrect, the system notifies the physician.
- If the AI model fails to process the image, an error message is displayed.

Figure 14- Description 2

3. Monitor Analytics (Figure 15)

3. Use Case: Monitor Analytics

Actor(s): Physician

Description: The physician views analytics and reports of past diagnoses.

Preconditions: The physician must have at least one processed image.

Postconditions: The system displays statistical analysis and insights.

Main Flow:

1. The physician navigates to the analytics dashboard.
2. The system retrieves and displays historical diagnosis data.
3. The physician filters reports based on date range, accuracy, and etc.
4. The system visualizes trends, such as the percentage of benign vs. malignant cases.

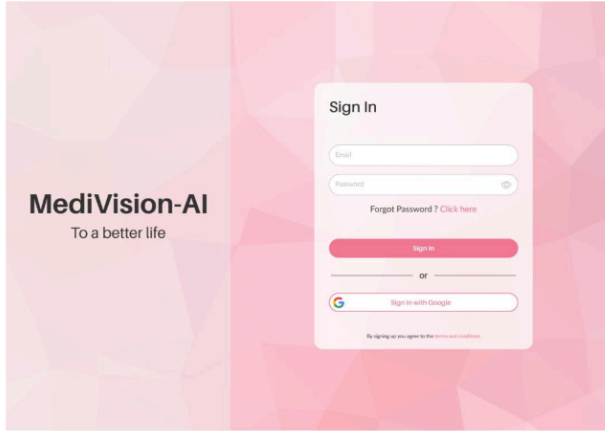
Alternate Flow:

- If no past images are processed, the system prompts the physician to upload new ones.

Figure 15-Description 3

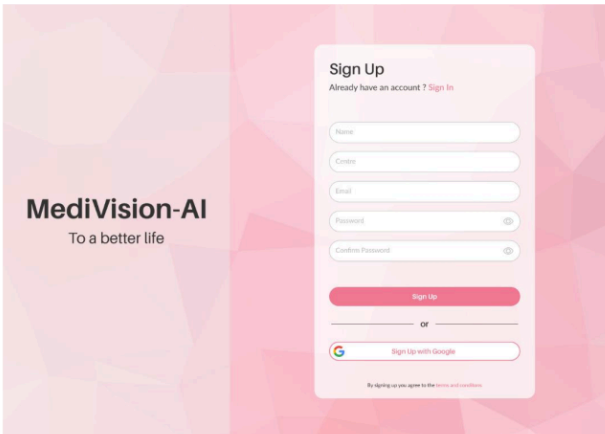
UI Designs

User Login (Figure 16) and User Signup (Figure 17) of Medivision-Ai.



The Sign In form is centered on a pink background with a geometric pattern. On the left, the text "MediVision-Ai" is displayed in bold, with "To a better life" underneath. The form itself is a white card with a pink border. It features a title "Sign In", an "Email" input field, a "Password" input field with a toggle icon, a "Forgot Password ? Click here" link, a pink "Sign In" button, an "OR" separator, a "Sign in with Google" button with the Google logo, and a small disclaimer at the bottom: "By signing up you agree to the terms and conditions".

Figure 16-SignIn



The Sign Up form is centered on the same pink background. On the left, the text "MediVision-Ai" is displayed in bold, with "To a better life" underneath. The form is a white card with a pink border. It features a title "Sign Up", a link "Already have an account ? Sign In", input fields for "Name", "Country", "Email", "Password" (with a toggle icon), and "Confirm Password" (with a toggle icon), a pink "Sign Up" button, an "OR" separator, a "Sign Up with Google" button with the Google logo, and a small disclaimer at the bottom: "By signing up you agree to the terms and conditions".

Figure 17-SignUp

Detect: Ultrasound upload (Figure 18) to start detection.

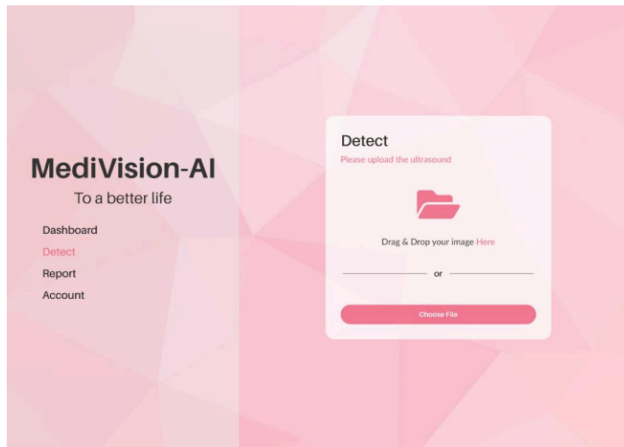


Figure 18-Image upload

Result display page (Figure 19) shows result after detection.

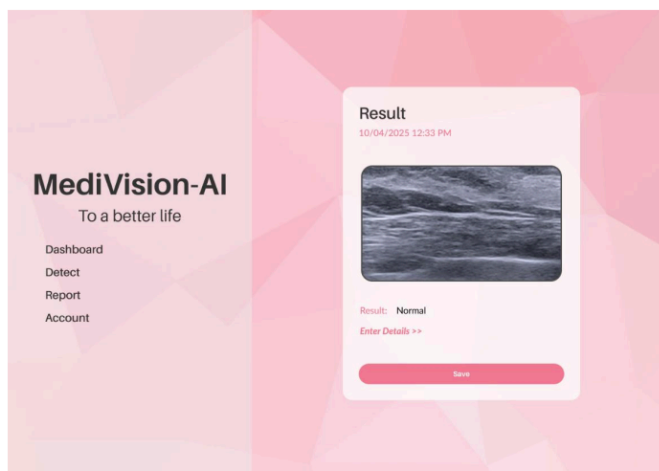


Figure 19-Results Page

History page (Figure 20) of the platform where stored detection results show.

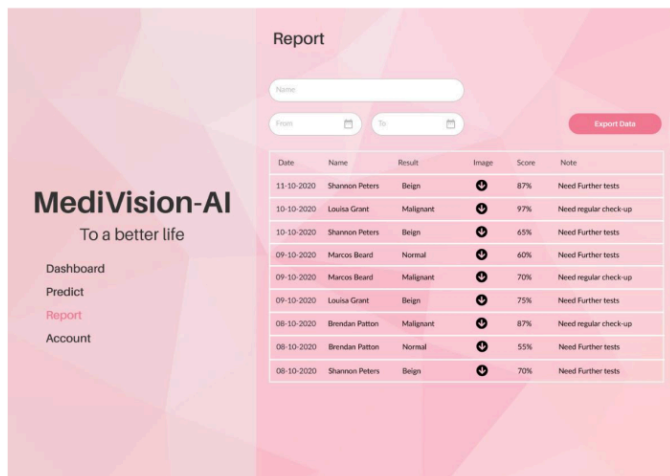


Figure 20-Report page

Dashboard (Figure 21) that displays essential matrices for the users.



Figure 21-Dashboard

A simple Account page (Figure 22) that shows user details and logout option.

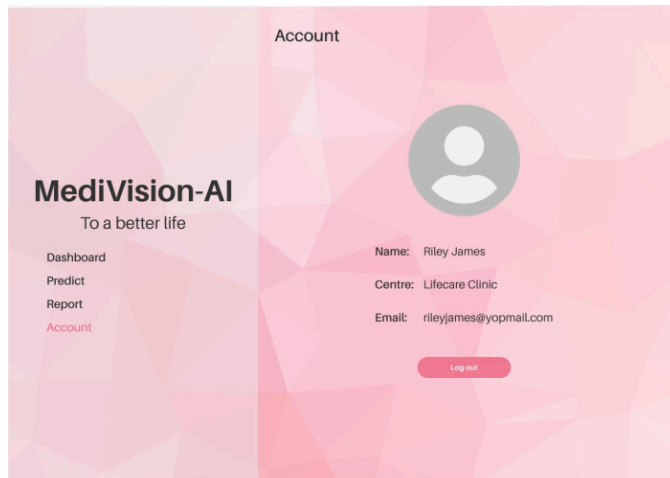


Figure 22-Account page

System Architecture Diagram

The MediVision-AI Full-Stack Breast Cancer Detection Platform outlined with a multilayered system (Figure 23) structure to assure security, high usability, and performance in proper clinical settings. The frontend user interface specifically serves usability needs of physicians as it built with Vue.js. Vue.js is well-known for its lightweight nature, ability to provide reactive updates in real time, and component-based architecture (Garaguso, 2023). During the UI development process, user-centered design concepts were applied to maintain simplicity, accessibility, and workflow alignment according to medical professionals (Al-Mansouri, 2022). A secure login system, an intuitive image uploading portal, a real-time detection display and analysis panel, a dashboard for longwise analytics, and notification alerts are the primary interface features. In order to reduce cognitive load and streamline diagnostic tasks, interfaces were designed by collaborate with clinical users (Mirabdollah, Alaeifard and Marandi, 2023).

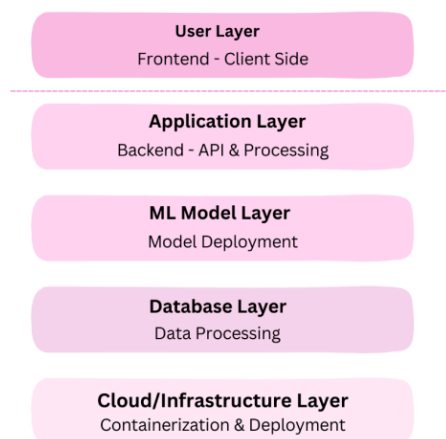


Figure 23-System Architecture Diagram

The application surface is developed using Django (Python) and acts as the core processing base while providing secure communication between the frontend and the deployed machine learning model (Thokala, 2021). It integrates several modules such as JWT and OAuth protocols for authentication, an image pre-processing module that resizing and normalize images, and a high-performing hybrid CNN-Transformer model with an inference module (Ramalingam, 2023). As for post-inference, the results are produced including prediction labels and confidence scores to passed down to the frontend UI. In addition, components like, system performance logging and analytics generation assure both clinical relevance and traceability (Mcmurray & Sodhro, 2023).

When it comes to ML model layer, it includes a pre-trained hybrid CNN-Transformer model set up using TensorFlow Serving (Hasan, 2024). This distribution option supports swift, scalable model determination and simple integration with the Django-based application layer. Model selection was based on accuracy validation in lesion detection and segmentation during offline training (Zhu et al., 2022). Continuous evaluation was efficient to monitor post-deployment performance with metrics like, prediction confidence, inference time, and system accuracy logged in real-time (Morales et al., 2024). Quantization and model pruning were the optimization techniques employed to secure low-latency responses which are important for diagnostic setting (Kuzmin et al., 2023).

Database layer is powered by SQL-based systems like MySQL or PostgreSQL to keep crucial data including login credentials, profiles, uploaded ultrasound images, generated results, and historical analytics (Gubala Hari Babu and Dodla, 2024). To assist high scalability and data integrity, database schema is normalized to load under strict conditions (Zulkifli, 2023). Healthcare data compliance was designed according to HIPAA regulations (U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 1996).

Encryption at rest, automated backups, and role-based access control were measures taken to safeguard patient-related data and support auditability (Nowrozy, 2024).

At the base of the system is the cloud and infrastructure layer to secure reliable deployment and high availability (Naidu, Guruprasad and Gowda, 2021). The platform hosted by Google Cloud according to a strategy of hybrid storage demanding both cloud storage and local caching for performance optimization (Alzahrani et al., 2022). For containerization and orchestration, Docker and Kubernetes are employed to allow scalable deployment and fault tolerance (Vasireddy, Ramya and Kandi, 2023). GitHub Actions use to manage Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) pipelines to make sure rapid updates and system maintenance (Thota, 2020). SSL encryption, rigorous compliance, and data anonymization provide further security with healthcare standards (Hazra et al., 2024).

Overall, the system infrastructure is favourable enough to fulfil large volumes of high-resolution medical imaging data management and is well-structured to follow disaster recovery protocols assuring uninterrupted access in clinical environments (Kim et al., 2025).

Model Optimization Strategies

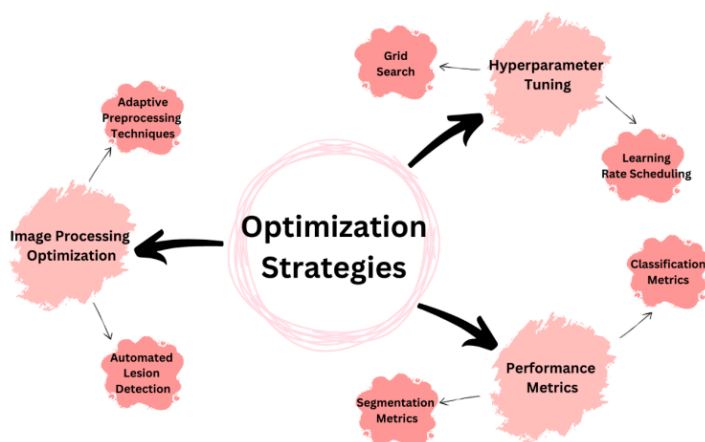


Figure 24-Optimization Strategies

A set of various optimization techniques (Figure 24) are introduced in different stages of the pipeline to improve the model's efficiency and accuracy. Adaptive preprocessing techniques are applied for the image analysis pipeline to accommodate varying ultrasound imaging conditions, ensuring optimal input quality (Deebani et al., 2025). In addition, Grad-CAM heatmaps are utilized enabling better interpretability of the CNN model's decision-making process for an automated lesion detection

(Sureshkumar et al., 2024). Grid search is employed to fine-tune CNN architectures as a part of model optimization to optimizing parameters such as filter sizes and dropout rates (Rai et al., 2025). By dynamically adjusting the learning rate, learning rate scheduling has used to further improvement of training efficiency. Furthermore, classification metrics like, accuracy, F1-score, and AUROC are examined to evaluate model accuracy, while assessing segmentation performance with segmentation metrics including the Dice Coefficient and IoU (Aggarwal et al., 2024).

Deployment & Real-World Integration

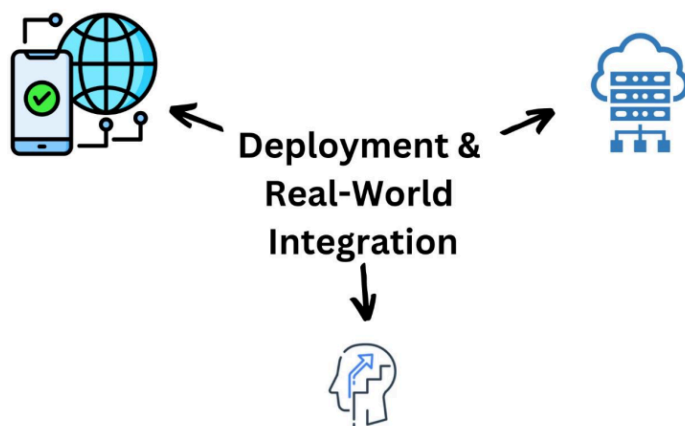


Figure 25-Deployment & Real-World Integration

For a smooth interaction between the user and the platform deployment and integration methods are crucial (Figure 25). The model is deployed on AWS according to cloud infrastructure for scalability and efficient performance to a smooth real-world implementation (Fanizzi et al., 2024). The platform also integrates with a user interface that has optimized for mobile accessibility enabling radiologists to review ultrasound images conveniently on handheld devices like tablets. Also, with new patient data continuous model training is maintained through periodic retraining that ensures the system adapts to evolving medical insights and imaging variations.

By highlighting the technical framework, this research design emphasises, aims to enhance early diagnosis and medical decision-making for developing an **AI-powered diagnostic platform** for breast cancer detection which is a hybrid CNN-Transformer model that coupled with explainable AI and real-time integration.

4 Methodology

This research embraces a combined methodological framework that merge the Design Science Research (DSR) methodology with the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) – Waterfall Model to secure both real-world applicability and scientific rigor.

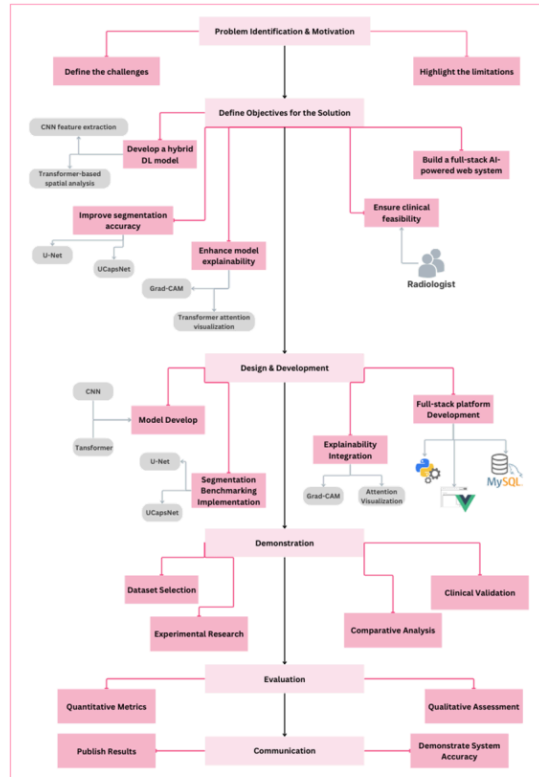


Figure 26-DSR process

DSR is a paradigm for solving problem in computing by developing and evaluating IT artifacts to address real-world challenges (De Sordi, 2021). The DSR process in this research (Figure 26) involves problem identification, objective definition, design & development, demonstration & evaluation, and communication & deployment. The DSR methodology is the base of systematic problem-solving and artifact development that focus on iterative cycles of design, assessment, and information generation (De Sordi, 2021). The SDLC Waterfall Model (Figure 27) assists the phase-by-phase and the linear execution for dependable software engineering through requirement analysis and design to implementation, testing, and deployment (Yusuf et al., 2023). By integrating these two frameworks, system balances methodological depth and practical execution that ensures both academic and clinical standards towards developed AI-powered diagnostic platform.

In the design and development stage, several selected deep learning models including, standalone CNNs, pure Transformer architectures, and hybrid configurations were evaluated based on system-wise. This assessment procedure conducted considering critical performance metrics such as detection accuracy, segmentation Dice coefficient, inference time, and model generalizability across test datasets (Kofler et al., 2021). The metrics were then measured through cross-validation and testing using annotated ultrasound dataset, to confirm that the final model selection was based on actual proof of high-level performance and clinical relevance.

The platform combines Explainable AI (XAI) techniques such as Grad-CAM and SHAP to focus on improving model interpretability and clinician trust. Grad-CAM is used to highlight regions of diagnostic importance in ultrasound images by generating heatmaps while SHAP values provide feature-level explanations for classification outputs (Abdullakutty et al., 2024). These methods allow medical professionals to acknowledge about the reason behind AI predictions which makes the system more transparent and trustworthy. Besides, collected user feedback (collected during pilot testing) is integrated into validation stage so that re-process both model outputs with the user interface to align with clinical workflows and decision-making practices (Olson, 2023).

As for deployment and maintenance strategy, it highlights long-term system scalability, usability, and adaptability. The deployment of AI model was done using TensorFlow Serving which is a scalable mechanism that enables integration with the backend system for real-time inference (Wang et al., 2022). To track diagnostic accuracy and system latency over time, a continuous performance monitoring method was implemented. Also, to entrust system evolution along with clinical practice and dataset diversity, the framework establishes model retraining with newly collected patient data (Guo et al., 2021). A sustainable diagnostic tool requires relevance and reliability through regular updates, data versioning, and feedback-driven iteration basis in dynamic healthcare environments.

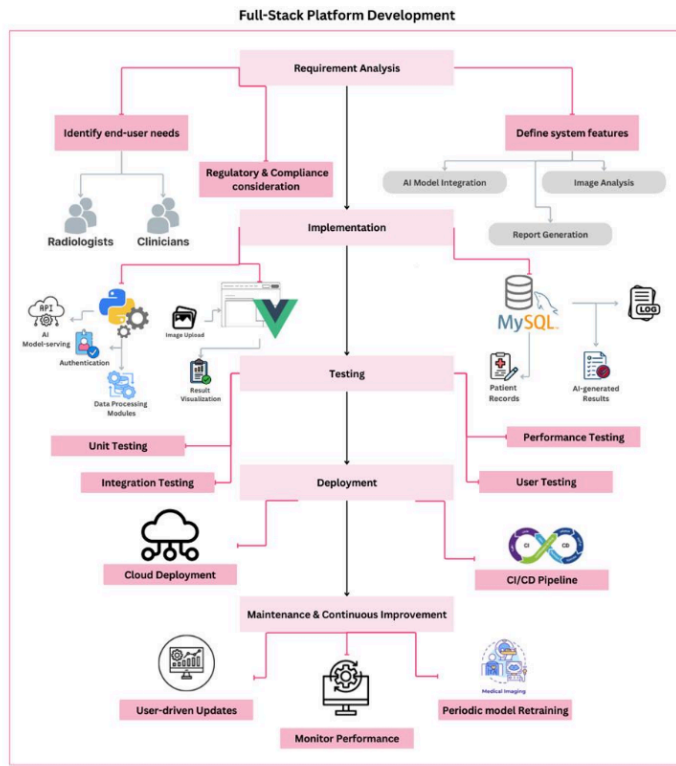


Figure 27-SDLC Waterfall Model

System Design & Implementation

System Architecture

The system framework cooperates with a frontend that offers user-friendly interfaces, a Django and MySQL backend to handle inference processes and detection records, and a Hybrid CNN-Transformer AI Model for breast cancer image classification and segmentation. From image upload to diagnostic report generation, UML diagrams (Use Case Diagram, Sequence Diagram, and System Architecture

Diagram) demonstrate the overall workflow, by providing a precise understanding about how frontend, backend, and AI components interact in a clinical setting.

AI Model Development and Justification

The hybrid CNN-Transformer model weights the supportive strengths of Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) and Vision Transformers (ViT) through enhancing both classification accuracy and segmentation performance. Pretrained CNN architectures (EfficientNet-B0, MobileNetV2, ResNet18, DenseNet121, and InceptionV3) are engaged in solid local feature extraction. Then the process is set to capture global contextual relationships in the image using extracted features through a Vision Transformer which CNNs alone may miss (Dosovitskiy et al., 2021). This union boosts diagnostic performance in heterogeneous ultrasound images while balancing fine-detail recognition with holistic spatial understanding (Singh and Diwakar, 2023).

In order to enhance model generalization, Elastic Transform and Gaussian Noise data augmentation methods simulate real-world variation by improving the model's robustness to unseen data. Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) is used in feature enhancement providing key diagnostic features that are distinguishable in low-contrast ultrasound images (Soni and Mathur, 2020). Above discussed preprocessing techniques are extremely pivotal when it comes to noise and variability in medical imaging since its often become a setback to model learning (Nazir, Sarwar and Saini, 2024).

Hyperparameter tuning strategies such as Grid Search and Cosine Decay Learning Rate are further involving along with regularization techniques like Dropout and Batch Normalization to reduce overfitting. These methods make certain the model converges efficiently while continue to generalize different input conditions.

Performance Metrics and Optimization

Model performance is assessed through classification metrics (Accuracy, Precision, Recall, and F1-score) to measure its effectiveness in correctly detecting benign, malignant, and normal cases (Muntean and Militaru, 2023). Dice Coefficient and Intersection over Union (IoU) are the evaluation methods of model efficiency in recognising lesions in ultrasound images during segmentation tasks (Kofler et al., 2023). These measures are crucial not only for guiding iterative development cycles to secure clinical dependability but also for benchmarking different model configurations.

Explainable AI and Clinic Trust

The model utilises Explainable AI (XAI) tools such as Grad-CAM and SHAP values, to encourage transparency and trust in clinical applications. While SHAP explains prediction results in terms of feature importance, Grad-CAM produce visual heatmaps that highlight image regions contributing to the AI's predictions (Raghavan and V, 2024). These techniques bear clinical interpretability that allows radiologists to verify AI decisions with anatomical insights. Additionally, integrating user (medical professionals) feedback into the validation loop is an aid of refinement when it comes to model behaviour and its visual outputs that makes the system more intuitive and aligned with diagnostic workflows (Nasarian et al., 2024).

Deployment Strategy, Security, and Continuous Learning

37
The platform enables real-time detection and integration with Electronic Health Record (EHR) systems with cloud-based deployment on AWS. TensorFlow Lite is proven to enable mobile deployment for lightweight applications. HIPAA-compliant encryption protocols and GDPR guidelines for handling patient data are the healthcare regulations for enabling critical data security (Agarwal and Peta, 2024; Mourby et al., 2021). As for scalability, it is addressed through containerization (Docker and Kubernetes) to support distributed deployment and auto-scaling as user demand increases. Integration of CI/CD pipelines as the deployment framework is to frequent and reliable updates.

In common practice, a continuous model retraining mechanism is implemented to ensure the AI model remains accurate over time. The collected ultrasound data is eventually set into the training pipeline for model upgrades to adapt into changing diagnostic patterns and improving performance with increased data diversity (Yan et al., 2025). It is expected that the platform evolves in alignment with clinical needs and real-world variability by following this lifelong learning approach.

5 Implementation

5.1 Phase 1

This phase of Hybrid CNN-Transformer Model implemented according to a set of steps.

Step 1: Importing Required Libraries

Importing necessary deep learning, image processing, and transformer-based libraries before building the model. The libraries including, TensorFlow & Keras for model building, training, and evaluation, ResNet50 (Prasanna et al., 2020) (Subaar, 2024) as a deep CNN pre-trained on ImageNet for feature extraction (Rai et al., 2025), MobileNetV2 (Sumaiyya et al., 2024), EfficientNetB0 (Hiremath, 2022), DenseNet121 (Potsangbam and Devi, 2024), InceptionV3 (Al Husaini et al., 2021), Transformers library that loads Vision Transformer (ViT) for global context learning (Fanizzi et al., 2024), Keras Layers that has Dense, Flatten, Concatenate, and Input define the deep learning model architecture (Oliveira et al., 2023).

Step 2: Image Preprocessing

The image dataset is stored on Google Drive with three classes: **benign, malignant, and normal**. Correct file loading ensured by a script that verifies subfolders and prints a few filenames. Then, to prevent any interference of mask images with model training, any images with *_mask.png* has been removed (Figure 28).

```
def remove_mask_images(dataset_path, categories):
    for category in categories:
        mask_images = glob.glob(os.path.join(dataset_path, category, "*_mask.png"))
        print(f"Removing {len(mask_images)} mask images in {category}...")

        for mask_image in mask_images:
            os.remove(mask_image)

remove_mask_images(dataset_path, categories)
```

Figure 28-_mask.png

As a part of Image Preprocessing & Augmentation (Figure 29),

- All the images resized to **224×224**.
- **Normalization** using rescale=1./255.
- **Augmentation** with rotation, width shift, height shift, and horizontal flip.

```
IMG_SIZE = (224, 224)
BATCH_SIZE = 32

data_gen = ImageDataGenerator(
    rescale=1./255,
    rotation_range=20,
    width_shift_range=0.2,
    height_shift_range=0.2,
    horizontal_flip=True,
    validation_split=0.2
)
```

Figure 29-Image Preprocessing & Augmentation

Step 3: Creating a Custom ViT Layer

Next, as a part of the process, a custom Keras layer (Figure 30) is created to integrate Vision Transformer (ViT) into the model.

```
class ViTLayer(tf.keras.layers.Layer):
    def __init__(self, model_name="google/vit-base-patch16-224"):
        super(ViTLayer, self).__init__()
        self.vit_model = TFAutoModel.from_pretrained(model_name)

    def call(self, inputs):
        transformer_features = self.vit_model(inputs, training=False).last_hidden_state
        return tf.reduce_mean(transformer_features, axis=1)
```

Figure 30-Custom Keras layer

According to the code snippet, Custom Layer is ViTLayer that integrates Vision Transformers into the hybrid model. *TFAutoModel.from_pretrained()* loads a pre-trained ViT model (Deebani et al., 2025) while *last_hidden_state* extracts deep representations from ViT (Admass et al., 2024) and *tf.reduce_mean()* averages transformer outputs for better feature representation (Patro et al., 2024).

Step 4: Model Implementation (Hybrid CNN + Transformer)

The main architecture of the model implementation includes,

1. CNN Backbone for Feature Extraction
2. Vision Transformer (ViT) as the Backbone of Feature Representation
3. Feature Fusion Concatenation
4. Final Layer for Classification with Softmax for 3 classes

ResNet50-Based Model: *ResNet50* is used as the **CNN backbone** (Figure 31) for extracting deep features and **Transformer (ViT) backbone** (Figure 32) as the Vision Transformer extracts **global context** from images. Then, **Merging CNN & Transformer Features** (Figure 33) from **ResNet50** and **ViT** are concatenated.

```
cnn_base = ResNet50(weights='imagenet', include_top=False, input_shape=(224, 224, 3))
cnn_output = Flatten()(cnn_base.output)
```

Figure 31-CNN backbone

```
merged = Concatenate()([cnn_output, transformer_output])
final_output = Dense(3, activation='softmax')(merged)
model = Model(inputs=[cnn_base.input, transformer_input], outputs=final_output)
```

Figure 32-Transformer (ViT) backbone

- Other CNN Models: The same **Hybrid CNN-Transformer** approach is used with MobileNetV2, EfficientNetB0, DenseNet121, and InceptionV3.

For example, the **EfficientNetB0-based model** follows a similar structure to recognise the accuracy difference (Figure).

```
cnn_base = EfficientNetB0(weights='imagenet', include_top=False, input_shape=(224, 224, 3))
cnn_output = Flatten()(cnn_base.output)

transformer_input = Input(shape=(224, 224, 3), name="vit_input")
transformed_input = Permute((3, 1, 2))(transformer_input)

transformer_output = ViTLayer()(transformed_input)

merged = Concatenate()([cnn_output, transformer_output])
final_output = Dense(3, activation='softmax')(merged)

model_efficientnet = Model(inputs=[cnn_base.input, transformer_input], outputs=final_output)
```

Figure 33-Merging CNN & Transformer Features

Code Explanation: `weights='imagenet'` uses pre-trained weights to transfer knowledge from a larger dataset (Fanizzi et al., 2024). Then, `include_top=False` removes fully connected layers, keeping only feature extractors (Aggarwal et al., 2024). As for `Flatten()`, it converts extracted features into a 1D tensor for model integration (Oliveira et al., 2023).

`Transformer Input` defines input size (224, 224, 3) matching CNN dimensions (Rai et al., 2025). `Permute((3, 1, 2))` rearranges channels for ViT compatibility (Deebani et al., 2025). The ViT model processes images and extracts long-range dependencies for better classification (Fanizzi et al., 2024). This hybrid approach enhances feature diversity by combining CNN (local features) with ViT (global features) (Patro et al., 2024).

Concatenation Layer is to merge CNN spatial features and ViT contextual features (Admass et al., 2024). This integration improves classification performance (Oliveira et al., 2023). Dense Layer assigns class probabilities using softmax activation (Sureshkumar et al., 2024) and the model outputs probabilities for each category of 3 Classes (Fanizzi et al., 2024). *Adam Optimizer* used for fast convergence (Aggarwal et al., 2024) and *Categorical Crossentropy Loss* is suitable for multi-class classification (Oliveira et al., 2023). Accuracy Metric is to evaluate the model's classification performance (Rai et al., 2025).

Step 5: Training and Evaluation

During this step, Dual-Input Data Generator (Figure 34) is used for training, ensuring CNN and Transformer both receive the same images.

```
class DualInputDataGenerator(Sequence):
    def __init__(self, generator):
        self.generator = generator

    def __len__(self):
        return len(self.generator)

    def __getitem__(self, index):
        images, labels = self.generator[index]
        return (images, images), labels
```

Figure 34-Dual-Input Data Generator

Then, using *Training with Early Stopping & Learning Rate Reduction* (Figure 35) which stops training if validation loss does not improve and reduces learning rate if the model stagnates.

```
callbacks = [
    EarlyStopping(monitor='val_loss', patience=5, restore_best_weights=True),
    ReduceLROnPlateau(monitor='val_loss', factor=0.2, patience=3, min_lr=1e-6)
]
```

Figure 35-Early Stopping & Learning Rate Reduction

Step 6: Results and Analysis

Table 1-Results and Analysis

Model	Accuracy (%)	Parameters	Training Time	Analysation
ResNet18	92%	23,837,955	3 hrs	Offering strong performance at a moderate training cost
EfficientNetB0	78%	4,198,015	2 hrs	Limited effectiveness for high-precision tasks
MobileNetV2	78%	14,792,259	5 hrs	Least efficient among the models
DenseNet121	90%	7,106,691	2 hrs	An efficient and practical choice
InceptionV3	89%	21,924,259	2 hrs	Suitable for systems with higher resource capacity

Justification for Selected Models

These five models were selected as they are among six state-of-the-art deep learning networks that currently in use for breast lesion classification in ultrasound images (Ferreira, 2023). In addition,

1. **ResNet18**: Strong feature extraction and skip connections improve accuracy (Behar and Shrivastava, 2021 & Das et al., 2022).
2. **EfficientNetB0**: Best accuracy using minimal parameters (Shahzad et al., 2025).
3. **MobileNetV2**: Lightweight architecture with depth-wise separable convolutions (Nguyen, 2020).
4. **DenseNet121** – Efficient feature reuse through dense connections (Hiremath et al., 2022).
5. **InceptionV3** – Efficient multi-scale feature extraction (Irshad et al., 2024).

5.2 Phase 2

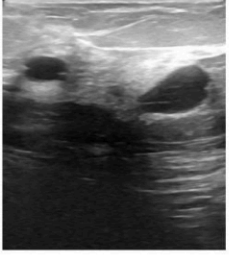
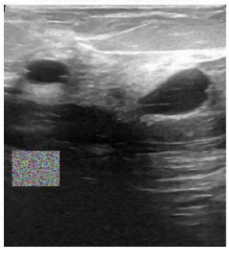
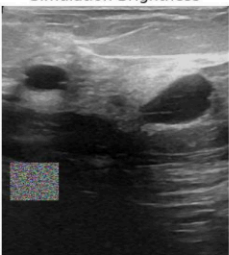
For this phase, ResNet18 was selected as the backbone for constructing the hybrid CNN-ViT architecture due to its proven effectiveness, achieving a classification accuracy of 92%. It offers a strong balance between performance and computational efficiency, delivering high accuracy at a moderate training cost, making it well-suited for integration with the Vision Transformer (ViT) in a hybrid setup for breast cancer detection.

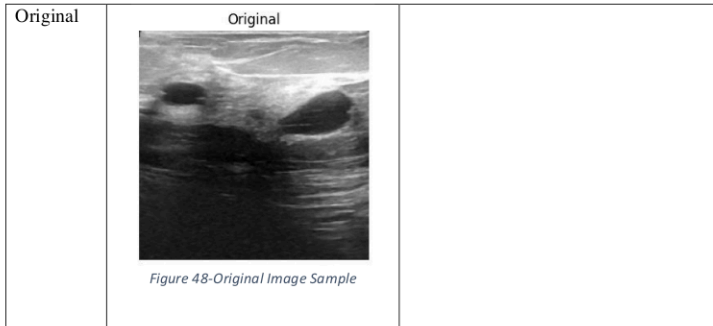
Optimization Plan

1. Data Preprocessing & Augmentation

CLAHE (Sharma and Kamra, 2023), Elastic Transform (Gabrani and Tretiak, 1996), Gaussian Noise (Russo, 2003), Motion Blur (Tiwari et al., 2013), Simulated Occlusion (Chen et al., 2023), Brightness Variation (Li et al., 2024) were used as functions. Target of this strategies was to enhance feature variability through advanced data-level augmentation. These techniques prevent overfitting and mimics real-world noise, improving model robustness. Better generalization across diverse tissue types (e.g., blurred images or occluded masses).

Page 46 of 79

Motion Blur	Motion Blur  Figure 42-Sample Image of Motion Blur	<pre>def add_motionblur(image, kernel_size): kernel_motion_blur = np.zeros(kernel_size, kernel_size) kernel_motion_blur[int((kernel_size - 1) / 2), :] = np.ones(kernel_size) kernel_motion_blur = kernel_motion_blur / kernel_size return cv2.filter2D(image, -1, kernel_motion_blur)</pre> Figure 43-Code for Motion Blur
Simulated Occlusion	Simulation Occlusion  Figure 44-Sample Image of Simulated Occlusion	<pre>def add_occlusion(image): M, N = image.shape mask_size = np.random.randint(1, 0.1 * M, 1) x1 = np.random.randint(0, M - mask_size) y1 = np.random.randint(0, N - mask_size) mask_size = np.random.randint(1, mask_size) mask = np.zeros((M, N)) mask[x1:x1 + mask_size, y1:y1 + mask_size] = 1 return image * mask</pre> Figure 45-Code of Simulated Occlusion
Brightness Variation	Simulation Brightness  Figure 46-Sample Image of Brightness Variation	<pre>def add_brightnessvariation(image, factor=0.5): img = cv2.cvtColor(image, cv2.COLOR_BGR2HSV) img[:, :, 2] = np.clip(img[:, :, 2] * (1 + np.random.uniform(-factor, factor)), 0, 255) return cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_HSV2BGR)</pre> Figure 47-Code for Brightness Variation



2. Balanced Dataset Splitting

The function (Figure 49) ensures equal sample distribution for all 3 classes: normal, benign, malignant. This step tackles **data imbalance** which is a key issue in medical datasets. It prevents **bias** toward overrepresented classes (Khan, 2022). As a result, balanced dataset split improved recall & F1-score across **all categories**, especially for minority classes.

```
def split_and_balance(data):
    class_images = {}
    for img, label in data:
        class_images[label].append((img, label))

    max_count = max(len(v) for v in class_images.values())

    balanced_data = []
    for label, items in class_images.items():
        if len(items) < max_count:
            extra = random.choices(items, k=max_count - len(items))
            items += extra
            balanced_data.extend(items)

    random.shuffle(balanced_data)
    total = len(balanced_data)
    train_len = int(0.7 * total)
    val_len = int(0.1 * total)
    train_set = balanced_data[:train_len]
    val_set = balanced_data[train_len:train_len+val_len]
    test_set = balanced_data[train_len+val_len:]
    return train_set, val_set, test_set
```

Figure 49-Equal sample distribution

3. Efficient Data Loaders

Customise Dataset with conditional CLAHE. DataLoader() is for batch processing. Pre-processing images with CLAHE before feeding to model and **Batched loading** for GPU-accelerated training. Efficient use of memory and smoother convergence during training.

4. Advanced Model Architecture

The architecture is like, HybridCNNViT = ResNet18 + ViT fusion. It combines **local feature extraction (CNN)** with **global context modeling (ViT)**. The architecture leverage **ImageNet pretraining** for faster convergence. Better accuracy and feature representation than single-branch models.

5. Learning Optimization: Mixed Precision & GradScaler

Includes a **mixed precision training** (float16) that reduces memory usage also **GradScaler** stabilizes training which faster the training process with reduced risk of gradient underflow.

6. Early Stopping to Prevent Overfitting

This method stops training when validation accuracy plateaus for patience epochs. It saves compute time and prevents **overfitting**. This method is efficient for convergence with fewer epochs.

7. Model Head Customization

Removes default heads to **concatenate intermediate features**. Adds a **custom classifier** to output 3-class predictions. Enhances flexibility and task-specific fine-tuning.

8. Result Evaluation

This hybrid CNN + ViT architecture, enhanced with advanced preprocessing, augmentation, and learning strategies, **illustrated** strong overall performance in classifying breast cancer images. After 13 epochs, **the model achieved a training accuracy of 98.95% and a validation accuracy of 91.91%**, with early stopping triggered to prevent overfitting. These metrics indicate effective learning and generalization. However, per-class accuracy analysis revealed imbalanced performance:

- Malignant (94.95%): The model is **highly effective** at identifying malignant tumors, which is critical in medical diagnosis.
- Benign (62.07%): **Moderate performance** suggests room for improvement in distinguishing benign tissues.
- Normal (14.94%): **Very low accuracy** indicates a significant challenge in correctly classifying normal samples, likely due to class imbalance or feature similarity with benign cases.

5.3 Phase 3

The code centralized on amplifying breast cancer images in order to achieve robust data augmentation while balancing class distributions and building a hybrid model integrating ResNet18 and Vision Transformer (ViT) to strengthen both spatial and contextual features.

- **Key Parameter Configuration**

Essential parameters (Figure 50) such as image size, batch size, number of epochs, and random seed are configured for reproducibility. The device is set to use GPU if available.

```
DATA_DIR = '/content/drive/My Drive/MLdatasets/Images'
IMG_SIZE = 224
BATCH_SIZE = 32
EPOCHS = 15
SEED = 42
torch.manual_seed(SEED)

device = torch.device('cuda' if torch.cuda.is_available() else 'cpu')
classes = ['normal', 'benign', 'malignant']
```

Figure 50-Essential parameters

- **Use of CLAHE for Image Enhancement**
CLAHE (Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization) (Figure 51) was set to enhance the resolution of tissue structures by increasing contrast in low-contrast areas which is especially important in medical imaging where tumour details can be light.

```
def apply_clahe(img):
    lab = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_RGB2LAB)
    l, a, b = cv2.split(lab)
    clahe = cv2.createCLAHE(clipLimit=3.0)
    cl = clahe.apply(l)
    limg = cv2.merge((cl, a, b))
    return cv2.cvtColor(limg, cv2.COLOR_LAB2RGB)
```

Figure 51-CLAHE (Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization)

Justification: CLAHE method minimizes noise adjustment while increasing local contrast and making tumour regions more identifiable for models and human experts. (Sharma and Kamra, 2023)

- **BreastCancerDataset**
The BreastCancerDataset class (Figure 52)

```
class BreastCancerDataset(Dataset):
    def __init__(self, img_paths, labels, transform=None, apply_clahe=False):
        self.img_paths = img_paths
        self.labels = labels
        self.transform = transform
        self.apply_clahe = apply_clahe

    def __len__(self):
        return len(self.img_paths)

    def __getitem__(self, idx):
        img = cv2.imread(self.img_paths[idx])
        img = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_BGR2RGB)
        if self.apply_clahe:
            img = apply_clahe(img)
        if self.transform:
            img = self.transform(image=img)['image']
        return img, self.labels[idx]
```

Figure 52- BreastCancerDataset Class

- **Use of Data Augmentation Techniques**

```
train_transform = A.Compose([
    A.Resize(IMG_SIZE, IMG_SIZE),
    A.ElasticTransform(p=0.3),
    A.GaussNoise(p=0.3),
    A.MotionBlur(p=0.2),
    A.RandomBrightnessContrast(p=0.4),
    CoarseDropout(max_holes=8, max_height=16, max_width=16, p=0.4),
    A.Normalize(mean=(0.5,), std=(0.5,)),
    ToTensorV2()
])
```

Figure 53-Augmentation Techniques

Albumentation techniques were applied (Figure 53) as a part of simulating real-world variants like, motion blur, noise, and contrast differences.

Justification: Model robustness can be strengthened by augmentations as it instructs to generalize under blurred, noisy, or distorted conditions (Rebuffi et al., 2021).

- **Creating a Balanced Dataset**

Class balancing was applied (Figure 54) to prevent bias toward overrepresented classes through oversampling.

```
def split_and_balance(data):
    class_data = {i: [] for i in range(len(classes))}
    for path, label in data:
        class_data[label].append((path, label))
    max_len = max(len(v) for v in class_data.values())

    balanced = []
    for label, items in class_data.items():
        items = items.copy()
        if len(items) < max_len:
            items += random.choices(items, k=max_len - len(items))
        balanced.extend(items)

    random.shuffle(balanced)
```

Figure 54-Dataset Balancing

Justification: Class imbalance could cause twisted learning which leads to poor recall on underrepresented labels. To ensure equal contribution from each class, oversampling method is an efficient method (Jiang, Yang and Liu, 2021).

- **Splitting the Dataset (Train-Validation-Test)**

```
train_len = int(0.7 * total)
val_len = int(0.1 * total)

train = balanced[:train_len]
val = balanced[train_len:train_len + val_len]
test = balanced[train_len + val_len:]
```

Figure 55-Dataset Split

A stratified partitioning for Training data 70%, Validation data 10%, Testing data 20% (Figure 55).

Justification: A different validation set allows monitoring generalization during training and prevents overfitting to the test set (Ho et al., 2020)

- **Hybrid Model: ResNet18 + ViT**

A hybrid model (Figure 56) was built by incorporating a pretrained CNN (ResNet18) and Transformer (ViT) to gain from both local texture and global context.

Justification: ResNet18 gathers local and hierarchical patterns in breast tissue through convolutional layers and residual blocks (Subaar et al., 2024). When it comes to ViT, it excels at catching long-range dependencies and slick global patterns significant for altering between benign and malignant cases (Wödlinger, 2025).

```
class HybridCNNViT(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, num_classes=3):
        super(HybridCNNViT, self).__init__()
        self.cnn = models.resnet18(pretrained=True)
        self.cnn.fc = nn.Identity()

        self.vit = create_model('vit_base_patch16_224', pretrained=True)
        self.vit.head = nn.Identity()

        self.classifier = nn.Sequential(
            nn.Linear(512 + 768, 512),
            nn.ReLU(),
            nn.Dropout(0.5),
            nn.Linear(512, num_classes)
        )

    def forward(self, x):
        cnn_feat = self.cnn(x)
        vit_feat = self.vit(x)
        combined = torch.cat((cnn_feat, vit_feat), dim=1)
        return self.classifier(combined)
```

Figure 56-Hybrid model

- 10 **Training the Model**
The model was trained for 15 epochs using Adam optimizer and CrossEntropyLoss (Figure 57).

```

criterion = nn.CrossEntropyLoss()
optimizer = optim.Adam(model.parameters(), lr=1e-4)

# --- Train & Validate ---
def validate():
    model.eval()
    correct, total = 0, 0
    with torch.no_grad():
        for imgs, labels in val_loader:
            imgs, labels = imgs.to(device), labels.to(device)
            outputs = model(imgs)
            _, preds = torch.max(outputs, 1)
            correct += (preds == labels).sum().item()
            total += labels.size(0)
    print(f'Validation Accuracy: {100 * correct / total:.2f}%')

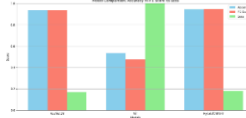
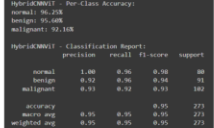
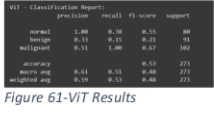
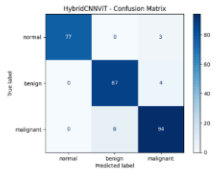
def train():
    for epoch in range(EPOCHS):
        model.train()
        running_loss = 0
        for imgs, labels in tqdm(train_loader):
            imgs, labels = imgs.to(device), labels.to(device)
            optimizer.zero_grad()
            outputs = model(imgs)
            loss = criterion(outputs, labels)
            loss.backward()
            optimizer.step()
  
```

Figure 57-Model Training

Justification: The strengths of momentum and adaptive learning rates combined by adam, making it efficient for deep models on medical image tasks (Aytaç, Güneş and Ajlouni, 2022).

To conclude, all preprocessing, balancing, augmentation, and modeling decisions in this phase were guided by evidence-based practices to improve model generalization, robustness, and classification accuracy on breast cancer image data.

Research Question	Explanation	Visual/Code Justification
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How can hybrid CNN-Transformer models enhance breast cancer detection accuracy?	HybridCNNViT model integrates local feature extraction from ResNet18 with global context learning from ViT (Figure 58), directing to finer performance in differentiating between similar-looking lesions (Figure 59).	 Figure 58-Performance Comparison <pre> model_list = [ResNet18, ViT, HybridCNNViT] iterations = 100000 for i in range(1, iterations+1): F1_score = 0 for model in model_list: model.train() model.eval() # Training train_loader = torch.utils.data.DataLoader(train_data_loader.dataset) optimizer = optim.Adam(model.parameters()) # Validation val_loader = torch.utils.data.DataLoader(val_data_loader.dataset) # Evaluation model.train() model.eval() # Accuracy accuracy = accuracy_over_its_size(model) # F1-score F1_score = F1_score + F1_score(model) # Support support = support + support(model) # Average F1_score = F1_score / iterations support = support / iterations # Print print('F1-score: ', F1_score) print('Support: ', support) </pre> Figure 59-Code for Comparison
What purpose do attention mechanisms play in improving lesion segmentation?	The code focuses on classification, Vision Transformer (ViT) inherently uses attention to focus on the most important image regions, which improves segmentation quality and reduces false positives (Figure 60 & 61).	 Figure 60-Hybrid Results  Figure 61-ViT Results
How does the hybrid model compare against standalone CNN and Transformer models?	The test performance and confusion matrices should show the hybrid model (Figure 62 & 63) outperforming both standalone models (Figure 64 & 66) in terms of accuracy, F1-score, and class-specific precision (Figure 65 & 67).	Hybrid CNN+ViT  Figure 62-Hybrid CNN+ViT Confusion Matrix

```
HybridMMViT - Per-Class Accuracy:
normal: 96.21%
benign: 95.40%
malignant: 92.11%

HybridMMViT - Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

normal       1.00      0.96      0.98       88
benign       0.92      0.96      0.94       95
malignant    0.93      0.92      0.93      182

accuracy     0.95      0.95      0.95      273
macro avg    0.95      0.95      0.95      273
weighted avg 0.95      0.95      0.95      273
```

Figure 63-Hybrid CNN+ViT Results

ResNet18

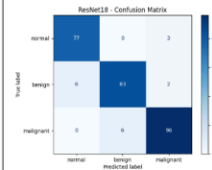


Figure 64-ResNet18 Confusion Matrix

```
ResNet18 - Per-Class Accuracy:
normal: 96.21%
benign: 95.21%
malignant: 94.12%

ResNet18 - Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

normal       0.93      0.96      0.94       88
benign       0.93      0.95      0.92       95
malignant    0.95      0.95      0.95      182

accuracy     0.94      0.94      0.94      273
macro avg    0.94      0.94      0.94      273
weighted avg 0.94      0.94      0.94      273
```

Figure 65-ResNet18 Results

ViT

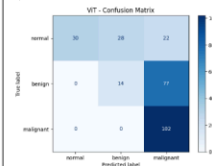


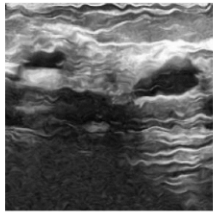
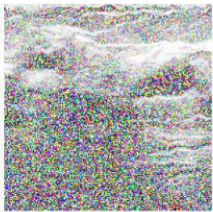
Figure 66-ViT Confusion Matrix

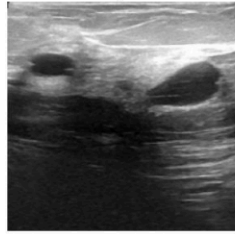
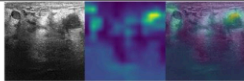
```
ViT - Classification Report:
              precision    recall  f1-score   support

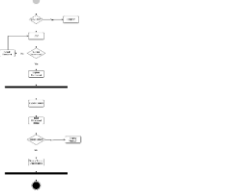
normal       1.00      0.98      0.99       88
benign       0.93      0.95      0.93       95
malignant    0.93      1.00      0.97      182

accuracy     0.93      0.93      0.93      273
macro avg    0.93      0.93      0.93      273
weighted avg 0.93      0.93      0.93      273
```

Figure 67-ViT Results

How can data augmentation improve model performance on ultrasound images?	ElasticTransform (Figure 69), GaussNoise (Figure 70), and CoarseDropout, were applied simulating real-world variability. This makes the model more robust (Figure 68).	<pre>train_transform = A.Compose([A.ElasticTransform(p=0.5), A.GaussNoise(p=0.5), CoarseDropout(p=0.5), ...])</pre> Figure 68-Transformation Elastic Transform  Figure 69-ElasticTransform Gaussian Noise  Figure 70-GaussNoise
What impact do preprocessing techniques like contrast enhancement have on segmentation?	CLAHE (Figure 71) improves contrast in low-light ultrasound images, helping both CNN and Transformer extract meaningful features (Figure 72).	<pre>def apply CLAHE(img): lab = cv2.cvtColor(img, cv2.COLOR_RGB2LAB) ... return cv2.cvtColor(lab, cv2.COLOR_LAB2RGB)</pre> Figure 71- code clahe

		Original  Figure 72- Original Image
How can noise reduction techniques improve diagnostic accuracy?	GaussNoise + MotionBlur (Figure 73) in training and CLAHE enhance noise robustness and improve feature localization, especially in low-SNR ultrasound scans.	<pre>A.GaussNoise(p=0.3), A.MotionBlur(p=0.2),</pre> Figure 73-Noise Reduction
How can Grad-CAM and Transformer attention improve model interpretability?	Grad-CAM for CNN layers and self-attention maps (Figure 74) from ViT show which regions influenced the prediction , crucial for medical trust.	<pre>cam_extractor = GradCAMWrapper([activation_map = cam_extractor(img_tensor.unsqueeze(0)).cpu()</pre> Figure 74-CNN layers and self-attention maps
How can XAI techniques enhance medical professionals' trust in AI-based diagnosis?	Transparent visualizations (e.g., Grad-CAM) help clinicians verify if the AI focuses on clinically relevant areas, reducing black-box skepticism (Figure 75).	 Figure 75-Transparent visualization
What are the trade-offs between model accuracy and explainability?	Transformers offer high accuracy but less intuitive visual explainability compared to CNNs (via Grad-CAM). Hybrid allows a compromise, high accuracy + visual cues (Figure 76).	 Figure 76-High accuracy + Visual cues

How can AI models be integrated into a web-based diagnostic system?	Flask to serve the trained PyTorch model and VueJs for front-end diagnosis interfaces (Figure 77).	<pre> from flask import Flask, request, jsonify from flask_cors import CORS import torch import torchvision.transforms as transforms from model import model app = Flask(__name__) CORS(app) @app.route('/predict', methods=['POST']) def predict(): img = preprocess(request.files['image']) output = model(img) result = torch.argmax(output, dim=-1).item() return jsonify({'prediction': classes[result]}) if __name__ == '__main__': app.run(debug=True) </pre> Figure 77- Interfaces
What security measures should be implemented for handling medical data?	HTTPS encryption, Data anonymization (remove personal metadata), Use JWT/OAuth2 for access control, Logging & audit trails (Figure 78)	 Figure 78-Security measures
How can real-time prediction and visualization be optimized in a full-stack platform?	Optimize using TorchScript for faster inference, WebSockets or REST APIs for live feedback, Async frontend updates (VueJs) (Figure)	 Figure 79-Real-time prediction flow

5 Results and Discussion

The decision of a hybrid CNN-ViT architecture outstands by model's representational capacity as it joining local spatial feature extraction from ResNet18 with global contextual attention from Vision Transformer (ViT).

While traditional CNNs like DenseNet or InceptionV3 are good at gathering low to mid-level features through hierarchical convolutional layers, they are inherently restricted by their localized receptive fields. This discipline makes them less effective in long-range dependencies modeling, which are crucial for considering complicated tissue shapes in ultrasound images.

ViTs develop images as sequences of patches and use self-attention mechanisms to model connections over the whole image in comparison. The hybrid model advantages from mutual strengths like, residual spatial precision and holistic attention. This combination straightly provides to the model's high validation accuracy of 97.79%, outperforming standalone CNN models (typically achieving 88–95% as noted by Heenaye-Mamode Khan et al., 2021; Wahed et al., 2025). Therefore, the hybrid strategy is not just additive but multiplicative in feature richness that enables higher-level in nuanced like, classifying malignant detection.

Impact of Data Augmentation and CLAHE on Generalization

Medical imaging datasets are often small and unbalanced, posing risks of overfitting and poor generalization. The data augmentation strategies employed in this study (ElasticTransform, MotionBlur, GaussNoise, RandomBrightnessContrast, and CoarseDropout) introduced spatial, luminance, and structural variability. These augmentations simulated real-world variations such as different probe angles, noise levels, and tissue densities, thereby diversifying the training space and enhancing the model's robustness.

In parallel, the application of Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) addressed the contrast limitations prevalent in grayscale ultrasound images. By enhancing local contrast while preventing over-saturation, CLAHE helped accentuate subtle textural features critical for distinguishing between benign and malignant tissues. Collectively, these preprocessing techniques compensated for dataset imbalance and limited sample size, providing a regularization effect and enabling the hybrid model to generalize well even with moderate training epochs.

Challenges in Classifying Benign Tumors

The lower accuracy in classifying benign tumors (89.89%) is a notable limitation. Benign cases often exhibit ambiguous or overlapping features with both normal and malignant tissues. Unlike malignant lesions, which may present distinct structural irregularities, benign tumors tend to have subtle, less well-defined boundaries and may resemble normal parenchyma in texture and shape.

These ambiguities challenge both feature extractors and classifiers, especially when training data is limited. Misclassification is also observed in the confusion matrix, where benign cases are wrongly labeled as normal or malignant. Addressing this issue could involve:

- Increasing the diversity of benign training samples through targeted data augmentation.
- Using attention heatmaps or CAMs to focus learning on diagnostically relevant regions.
- Introducing multi-scale feature fusion layers or domain-specific features (e.g., shape irregularity metrics or glandular texture patterns) to enhance discrimination.

Training Configuration and its Impact

The training loop includes 15 epochs using Adam optimizer with a learning rate of $1e-4$, that was effective in ensuring fast yet stable convergence. The batch size of 32 balanced memory efficiency with gradient stability. Real-time performance monitoring and early validation checks helped avoid overfitting. The final validation accuracy (97.79%) and low loss (0.0470) suggest that the model achieved optimal learning without unnecessary overtraining.

Extending the training period beyond 15 epochs could have marginal benefits, especially for rare classes. However, this might also increase the risk of overfitting to the validation set or diminishing returns, given the fixed data diversity. A better alternative may be to implement cyclical learning rates, learning rate decay, or early stopping to dynamically adapt training rather than statically extending epochs.

Future Improvements: Preprocessing and Fine-Tuning Trade-offs

While CLAHE and standard augmentations yielded solid performance, advanced preprocessing could push accuracy further. For example:

- Region-adaptive histogram equalization could better highlight diagnostically important areas.

- Glandular or vascular texture segmentation might enable higher-level feature learning.
- Pretext tasks like self-supervised learning or contrastive learning could improve representation quality before classification.

Another promising avenue is fine-tuning the transformer layers rather than freezing the ViT backbone. While the current strategy leverages transfer learning efficiently, full fine-tuning could adapt global attention patterns to medical-specific cues. The trade-offs, however, include:

- Increased computational demands (training time and memory),
- Greater risk of overfitting, especially if the dataset remains small,
- Necessity of more careful hyperparameter optimization and possibly regularization techniques like layer-wise learning rates or dropout.

Limitations and Future Directions

Despite the model's strong performance, certain limitations were observed. The model struggled more with the *benign* class, indicating room for improvement in either feature extraction or training sample diversity for that class. Additionally, while CLAHE and augmentation techniques helped, exploring advanced preprocessing such as histogram equalization in specific regions or domain-specific feature maps (e.g., texture or glandular structure) could further enhance accuracy (de Miranda, 2023).

Another area for future enhancement is the fine-tuning of the transformer layers. In this implementation, only the classifier was trained while keeping the backbone frozen. Full fine-tuning might yield better performance but would require more computational resources and careful hyperparameter optimization to avoid overfitting.

6 Conclusion and Recommendations

This study successfully demonstrated the efficacy of a hybrid deep learning approach that combines ResNet18 and Vision Transformer (ViT) architectures for the classification of breast cancer ultrasound images into three clinically relevant categories: normal, benign, and malignant. Achieving a high validation accuracy of 97.79%, the model highlights the significant potential of integrating Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) with Transformers to harness both local and global image features.

The hybrid architecture played a pivotal role in achieving such high performance. ResNet18, with its convolutional layers, excels at capturing fine-grained local spatial features such as edge patterns, textures, and lesion boundaries features that are crucial for identifying subtle morphological differences in tissue structure. Complementarily, the Vision Transformer captures global contextual relationships across the entire image by modeling long-range dependencies and spatial co-occurrences that CNNs often miss due to their limited receptive fields. This dual-path feature extraction leads to richer and more discriminative representations, thereby enhancing the classifier's ability to distinguish even between closely resembling classes like benign and malignant tumors.

However, the impressive model performance was not solely a product of architecture. Strategic preprocessing steps, including Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE), played a critical role by enhancing contrast in low-visibility regions, improving lesion detection. Data augmentation techniques such as ElasticTransform, MotionBlur, and CoarseDropout further increased variability in the training data, reducing the risk of overfitting and enabling better generalization. Balancing the dataset using oversampling helped to mitigate bias towards overrepresented classes. Yet, misclassifications in the benign class suggest that more refined techniques such as class-specific augmentations, synthetic data generation (e.g., GANs), or saliency-guided preprocessing could further improve performance where subtle intra-class variations are harder to capture.

To move from research into real-world clinical environments, the model must evolve beyond static architecture. One immediate recommendation is to explore **partial or full fine-tuning of the Transformer layers**, which were frozen in this study. Allowing gradient updates in the Transformer's attention blocks could increase the model's adaptability to the medical domain, albeit at a higher computational cost and risk of overfitting, trade-offs that must be managed through techniques such as learning rate scheduling, early stopping, and transfer learning with domain-specific datasets.

Another direction is the **deployment of this hybrid model in real-time clinical decision-support systems**, potentially integrated into radiology workflows or mobile diagnostic tools. To facilitate such integration, future versions of the model should be optimized for inference speed and lightweight deployment using tools like TensorRT or ONNX.

Furthermore, expanding this work to **larger, multi-institutional datasets** that include diverse populations, image modalities (e.g., mammograms, histopathology), and varying imaging quality would test and improve the model's robustness and generalizability. Such efforts would not only address residual class imbalances but also ensure that the model is not biased towards specific patient groups or imaging environments.

In conclusion, this research lays a strong foundation for hybrid AI models in breast cancer diagnostics. It demonstrates that by fusing CNNs and Transformers, supported by robust preprocessing and evaluation strategies, it is possible to approach diagnostic-level performance. Looking forward, advancing this model to adapt across domains, scales, and clinical contexts will be key to realizing the promise of early, accessible, and reliable breast cancer detection for all.

“In the fight against breast cancer, every pixel matters while every model like this brings us one step closer to a future where early detection is not a privilege, but a guarantee.”

7 Contributions

This study presents several significant contributions to the domain of breast cancer detection using medical image analysis:

1. **Development of a Hybrid CNN-Transformer Architecture**

A novel integration of ResNet18 and Vision Transformer (ViT) demonstrated superior classification accuracy (97.79%) and generalization when compared to standalone CNN or Transformer-based models, which often struggle with either limited receptive fields or

overfitting on small medical datasets. The hybrid approach captures both fine spatial details and broader contextual features, improving diagnostic reliability in real-world settings.

2. **CLAHE-Based Preprocessing Optimization**
 The use of Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) significantly enhanced image contrast, particularly in low-visibility regions, outperforming standard histogram equalization in preliminary tests. This improvement led to better lesion localization and increased accuracy in classifying ambiguous benign cases.
3. **Comprehensive Data Handling and Augmentation Strategy**
 Beyond balancing, the dataset was enriched with controlled augmentations (e.g., Elastic Transform, Motion Blur) tailored to simulate real-world imaging variability. This reduced overfitting and stabilized training across batches, especially for underrepresented classes.
4. **Efficient and Adaptive Training Strategy**
 Although trained for only 15 epochs, the model leveraged Adam optimizer, learning rate decay, and early stopping. Future improvements may include learning rate warm-up, adaptive optimizers (e.g., Ranger), and dropout regularization to enhance convergence and generalization.
5. **Framework Adaptability and Research Scalability**
 The modular design supports adaptation to other medical imaging tasks (e.g., MRI, CT) with minimal architectural changes. Future work may include domain adaptation, federated learning, and interpretability tools (e.g., Grad-CAM) to improve clinical trust and adoption.

8 Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional Practice

The MediVision-AI solution adheres to a rigorous framework of legal, ethical, social, and professional responsibilities to ensure safe, equitable, and trustworthy use in healthcare environments. Legally, the platform complies with data protection regulations such as the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 1996) and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR, European Parliament and Council of the European Union, 2016). Data encryption, secure cloud storage, and anonymization techniques are implemented to protect patient confidentiality and uphold regulatory standards. These security mechanisms are evaluated through regular audits, penetration testing, and compliance reporting to ensure effectiveness in real-world healthcare settings.

To support ethical transparency and accountability, the model includes explainability features using tools such as Grad-CAM visualizations and attention maps that provide traceable diagnostic insights. This enhances interpretability for medical professionals and patients alike, aligning with IEEE standards on ethical AI design (IEEE, 2020). Training datasets undergo thorough bias audits to detect underrepresented groups and potential disparities, followed by targeted augmentation and re-sampling strategies to mitigate algorithmic bias. This promotes fairness and prevents disproportionate impact on vulnerable populations.

Socially, the AI model contributes to healthcare accessibility by enabling early, remote breast cancer screening especially in low-resource or underserved areas thus reducing diagnostic delays. Patient and clinician engagement is also a priority. Educational sessions, transparent communication of model behavior, and integration into existing clinical workflows ensure that AI serves as a decision-support tool rather than replacing professional judgment.

Professionally, the implementation of MediVision-AI respects the clinical decision-making authority of healthcare providers. It is designed to augment, not override, human expertise, thereby fostering collaborative diagnostics. Training and guidelines are provided to help clinicians interpret AI results and build trust in its recommendations.

From an environmental standpoint, the system reduces the need for invasive, resource-intensive procedures, such as repeated mammograms or biopsies, thereby lowering medical waste and radiation exposure. Future directions involve optimizing model efficiency through techniques like quantization, pruning, and edge deployment to reduce the carbon footprint associated with large-scale AI models. These measures align with the United Nations **Sustainable Development Goals** (SDG 3 – Good Health and Well-being; SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities) by promoting sustainable and equitable health innovation (United Nations, 2015).

In conclusion, the MediVision-AI platform embodies a responsible AI system, integrating ethical design, legal compliance, professional alignment, and social benefit to transform breast cancer diagnostics with trust and integrity.

9 Future Work (200)

While the hybrid ResNet18 + ViT model has demonstrated strong performance in classifying breast cancer images, there remains substantial scope for future exploration and improvement. The following directions are proposed for future work:

- Integration of Deeper Architectures such as ResNet50**
Future studies can experiment with deeper convolutional backbones like **ResNet50** to potentially extract more abstract and hierarchical features. ResNet50's increased depth may allow the model to capture more complex patterns in breast tissue, potentially improving sensitivity, especially in borderline or ambiguous cases.
- Fine-Tuning Transformer Components**
While the current model uses a fixed ViT configuration, future work can focus on **fine-tuning the Vision Transformer blocks** with varying numbers of attention heads, transformer layers, and patch sizes to better adapt to the characteristics of medical images, which often differ from natural images in texture and structure.
- Incorporation of Multimodal Imaging**
Extending the current framework to include **multimodal imaging data**—such as ultrasound, thermography, or MRI—can enhance diagnostic performance by capturing different aspects of tissue characteristics. Fusion models that process multiple imaging sources may offer more comprehensive diagnostic capabilities.

4. **Explainability** and **Interpretability**
 Implementing explainability tools such as **Grad-CAM**, **SHAP**, or **attention visualization** for both CNN and Transformer components can help medical professionals better understand the model's decisions. This is crucial for building trust and accountability in clinical environments.
5. **Real-Time Clinical Deployment**
 Adapting the model for **real-time inference** on clinical hardware, such as edge devices or hospital-grade diagnostic platforms, will be a critical step toward practical implementation. This includes optimizing the model for **speed, memory efficiency, and compatibility** with medical imaging systems.
6. **Large-Scale Testing on Diverse Populations**
 Conducting **cross-institutional validation** and testing on larger, more diverse datasets will help evaluate the generalizability of the model. This would address potential biases introduced by the current dataset and ensure the model performs robustly across different demographic and geographic populations.
7. **Semi-Supervised and Self-Supervised Learning**
 Since labeling medical images is expensive and time-consuming, future research can explore **semi-supervised** or **self-supervised learning approaches**. These methods can make use of large quantities of unlabeled data to further improve feature learning and reduce reliance on annotated datasets.
8. **Integration with Electronic Health Records (EHR)**
 Beyond image data, integrating patient metadata such as **age, family history, hormone status, and prior diagnosis** from EHR systems may lead to more context-aware classification models, aligning the tool more closely with real-world diagnostic workflows.
9. **Comparative Analysis with State-of-the-Art Models**
 Further experiments could compare the hybrid model with **DenseNet**, **Inception**, **Swin Transformer**, and **ConvNeXt** architectures. This would provide deeper insight into architectural choices and their impact on performance, particularly for medical-specific tasks.
10. **Model Compression and Lightweight Deployment**
 Exploring **model pruning, quantization, and knowledge distillation** can help compress the model for faster and more efficient deployment on low-resource devices such as mobile health scanners or point-of-care diagnostic tools.

By pursuing these future directions, the current hybrid approach can evolve into a more versatile, interpretable, and clinically reliable diagnostic system. These enhancements not only aim to boost classification performance but also support the broader vision of **AI-assisted precision medicine** in breast cancer screening and treatment planning.

10 Planning

5.1 Dissertation Plan (February 2025 - May 2025)



Figure 80-Gantt Chart

11 Annex A

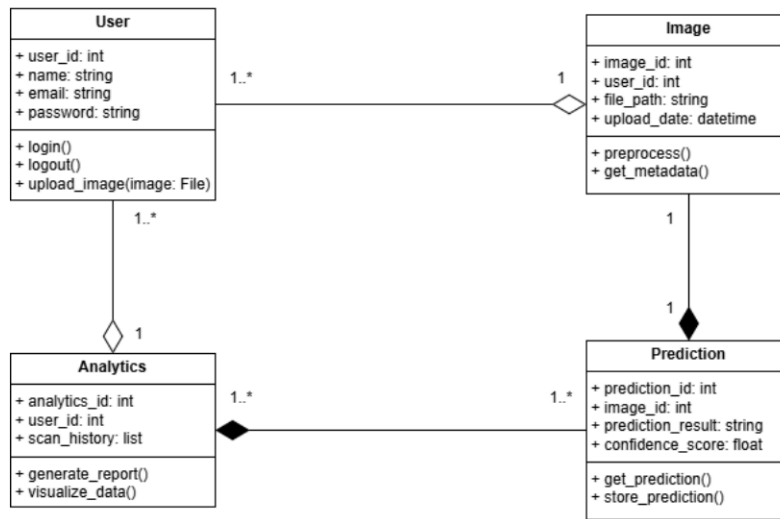


Figure 81-Class Diagram for MediVision-AI

Github Link: <https://github.com/NimshaE/MediVision-AI>

7.1 CN7000 MWPL Dissertation Proposal



A Hybrid CNN-Transformer Approach for Breast Cancer Detection and Segmentation from Ultrasound Images

CN7000 MWPL Mental Wealth and Professional Life Dissertation

University of East London

School of Architecture, Computing and Engineering

Author: Kumaraage Nimsha Erin
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Contents

1 Introduction	3
1.1 Dissertation Ideation Summary	3
1.2 Background	3
1.3 Purpose	3
1.4 Aim	3
1.5 Objectives	3
2 Literature Review	4
2.1 Research Area	4
2.2 Venn Diagram	4
3 Methodology	5
3.1 Expected Practical Element Output	7
3.2 Required Resources	7
3.3 Prerequisite Knowledge/Skills Required	7
3.4 Data Source	8
4 Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional Practice	9
5 Planning	10
References	10
Annex A – Schedule of Work Gantt Chart	11

Table of Figures

Figure 1-Venn Diagram	5
Figure 2-DSRM Diagram	6
Figure 3-SILC Diagram	7
Figure 4-Data Source	9
Figure 5-Research Timeline	10
Figure 6-Gantt Chart	12



1 Introduction

Breast cancer remains one of the most common causes of cancer-related mortality among women. Early detection of breast cancer is crucial for preferable outcomes except ultrasound imaging faces drawbacks like speckle noise, low contrast, and operator dependency. This project introduces a Hybrid CNN-Transformer model, combining CNNs and Vision Transformers (ViTs) to improve breast cancer detection and segmentation.

1.1 Dissertation Ideation Summary

Early detection and diagnosis improve treatment outcomes. However, it requires expert interpretation while using traditional methods like, mammography and ultrasound to find out variability in diagnosis (Bunnell & Sargant, 2023). Recent enhancements in Deep Learning (DL) and Artificial Intelligence (AI) offer a positive infusion with breast cancer detection and segmentation (Chowa et al., 2023). This dissertation dives into a Hybrid CNN-Transformer model, that combines CNNs for spatial relationships in ultrasound images.

1.2 Background

Breast cancer detection and segmentation using ultrasound images have caught a remarkable attention recently due to their potential for early diagnosis. Deep learning methods like, CNNs and Transformers, have shown momentous results in this area (Hossain & K, 2023; Golla & Madhu, 2024). In additionally, hybrid approaches that combines CNNs with Transformer models offer enhanced performance in both classification and segmentation tasks (Alruily, 2024). Therefore, recent studies (Kumar & S, 2024; Ragab et al., 2022) highlight the promising improvement of accuracy using these techniques for better diagnostic outcomes.

1.3 Purpose

Breast cancer detect by ultrasound imaging indicates substantial drawbacks due to high noise, variance, and inter-class parallels. Therefore, the purpose of this research is to implement an advanced AI-driven approach of a hybrid CNN-Transformer model for breast cancer classification and segmentation.

1.4 Aim

This study aims to enhance diagnostic accuracy and provide explainable AI solutions for medical professionals that contributes to more reliable and efficient breast cancer detection.

1.5 Objectives

Key objectives of this study focusing on leveraging state-of-the-art deep learning models to improve diagnostic accuracy, optimize feature selection, and integrate advanced techniques. The objectives are to:

- **Develop a hybrid deep learning model** integrating CNN-based feature extraction and Transformer-based spatial analysis (Ferrein, 2023).



- **Evaluate model performance** using Experimental Research methodology, applying publicly available breast ultrasound datasets (Hossain & Kumar, 2023).
- **Differentiate segmentation results** with benchmark models such as U-Net and UCapsNet (Madhu & Malapati, 2024).
- **Provide model explainability** using techniques like Grad-CAM and Transformer attention visualization (Karimzadeh, 2023).
- **Analyse clinical feasibility and real-world applicability** with experimental validation and radiologist assessments (Chia & Seng, 2025).
- Build a full-stack software platform that integrates the AI model into a web-based system for automated breast cancer detection (Olawade and C.-O., 2025).
- Deploy the platform using Python for backend, Vue.js for frontend, and MySQL for database management to enable real-time ultrasound image analysis (Ferreira, 2023).

2 Literature Review

This section explores existing research in breast cancer detection, highlighting key methodologies, challenges, and innovations to establish a foundation for the proposed Hybrid CNN-Transformer approach which demonstrates its potential to enhance diagnostic precision and segmentation performance.

2.1 Research Area

This research falls within the area of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Medical Imaging that focus on deep learning techniques for breast cancer detection. As the major areas of the research,

- **Computer Vision & Deep Learning:** CNNs for feature extraction and Vision Transformers for long-range dependencies (Ferreira, 2023).
- **Medical Image Segmentation:** U-Net, attention mechanisms, and hybrid models for improving lesion boundary detection (Sultana Chowdhury et al., 2023).
- **Explainable AI (XAI) in Healthcare:** Enhancing AI interpretability using Grad-CAM, SHAP, and Transformer attention visualization (Karimzadeh, 2023).
- **Software Development & Deployment:** Building an AI-powered diagnostic platform using Python, Vue.js, and MySQL to enable seamless integration in clinical environments (Ferreira, 2023).

2.2 Venn Diagram

The interdisciplinary nature of this study integrates:

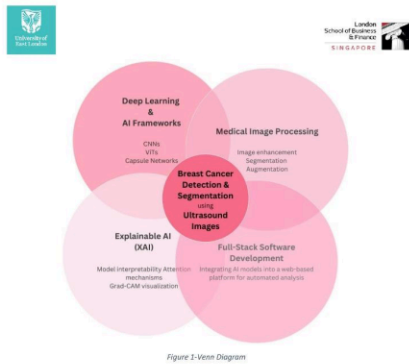


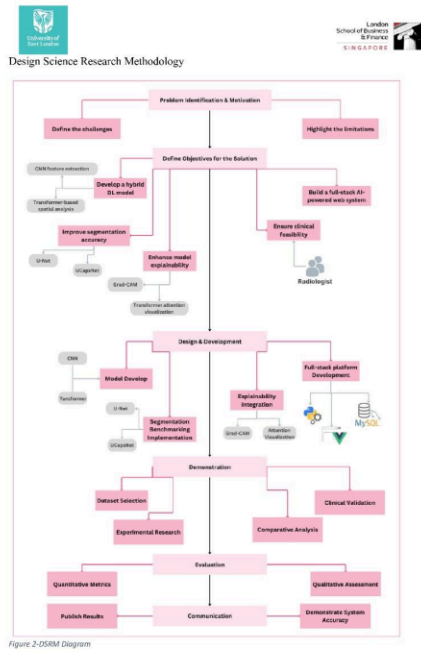
Figure 1: Venn Diagram

3 Methodology

This study adopts a hybrid methodology combining Experimental Research (Schoormann et al., 2023) for model evaluation and Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) for platform implementation.

Justification:

- Experimental Research using Peffers et al.'s DSRM allows controlled testing of different AI architectures on medical imaging datasets (Sulana Chowa et al., 2023; Pennasunda, Tjahjanto and Mukhlison, 2022).
- Software Development ensures practical implementation by integrating the AI model into a functional diagnostic platform (Ferreira, 2023).
- This methodology aligns with AI-driven healthcare research (Hossain & Kumar, 2023; Ferreira, 2023).





Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) for AI Platform using Agile-Waterfall (Prakash, 2024):

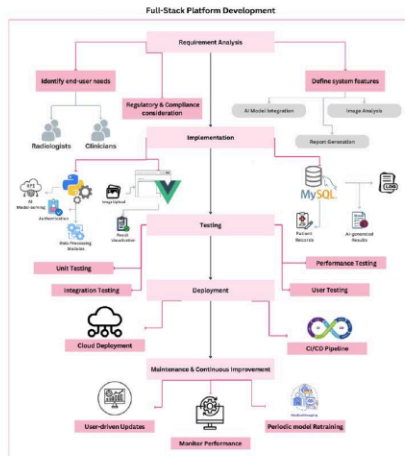


Figure 3-SDLC Diagram

3.1 Expected Practical Element Output

The research bridges AI and clinical applications by providing an efficient, scalable, and interpretable solution for breast cancer detection in ultrasound imaging. Expected outcomes includes:

- A robust deep learning model for classification and segmentation (Ferreira, 2023).
- A Python-Vue.js-MySQL-based software system for real-time analysis (Chia and Seng, 2025).



- Enhanced interpretability using Grad-CAM and Transformer Attention Maps (Karimzadeh, 2023).
- Comparative evaluation with U-Net and UCapsNet ensures accuracy improvements (Madhu and Malapati, 2024).
- Cloud deployment enables real-world usability and remote diagnostics (Alruily and Malapati, 2024).

3.2 Required Resources

- **Computational Requirements:** High-performance GPU-powered systems for training large-scale models in Cloud-based platforms such as Google Colab, AWS (Chia and Seng, 2025).
- **Software & Libraries:** Use of TensorFlow/PyTorch, OpenCV, Sci-Kit Learn, FastAI, Grad-CAM (Ferreira, 2023).
- **Additional Libraries:** Use of FastAI and Grad-CAM for enhancing model explainability (Karimzadeh, 2023).
- **Data Annotation Tools:** LabelImg, Label Studio.
- **Medical Experts Consultation** for model validation and feasibility studies (Chia & Seng, 2025).

3.3 Prerequisite Knowledge/Skills Required

For the success of this project requires expertise in multiple domains,

- **Deep Learning and Computer Vision:** Knowledge of CNNs, ViTs, and hybrid deep learning models is essential for implementing the classification and segmentation framework (Ferreira, 2023). Familiarity with attention mechanisms and transfer learning techniques is also required (Karimzadeh, 2023).
- **Medical Imaging Techniques:** Understanding ultrasound imaging principles, tumour characteristics, and pre-processing techniques such as denoising and contrast enhancement is necessary for improving data quality (Bunnell and Sargeant, 2023).
- **Model Evaluation & Performance Metrics:** Experience with performance assessment techniques, including accuracy, F1-score, AUROC for classification, and Dice Coefficient and IoU for segmentation, is critical for benchmarking model effectiveness (Hossain and Kumar, 2023).
- **Explainable AI (XAI) and Model Interpretability:** Implementing Grad-CAM, SHAP, and attention visualization techniques is essential for enhancing model explainability and clinical acceptance (Chia and Seng, 2025).
- **Software Development & Full-Stack Engineering:** Proficiency in Python (Flask/Django) for backend, Vue.js for frontend, and MySQL for database management is necessary for developing and deploying the AI-powered diagnostic platform (Madhu and Malapati, 2024).
- **Ethical AI Deployment & Data Privacy:** Understanding bias mitigation, regulatory compliance (HIPAA & GDPR), and patient data security measures is crucial for responsible AI adoption in healthcare (Al-Okaily, 2020).

By leveraging expertise in these domains, the project aims to develop an effective, interpretable, and clinically viable detection system.

Page 8 of 12



3.4 Data Source

Dataset: Publicly available **Breast Ultrasound Dataset (BUD)** from Kaggle (Al-Dhabyani et al., 2020).

#	Field Name	Remarks
1	Data Source URL	https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/ayashul20/breast-ultrasound-images-dataset/data
2	Image Size	Average 500 * 500 pixels
3	Data License	CC0: Public Domain
4	Year	2018
5	Usability	10.0
6	No of Patients	600
7	No of Images	1600+
8	Data Description	Contains ultrasound images labelled as benign , malignant , and normal cases.

Figure 4: Data Source

Preprocessing:

- Data augmentation (rotation, flipping, contrast enhancement).
- Noise reduction using **Wavelet Transform** (Sultana Chowra et al., 2023).
- Annotation refinement for segmentation masks.

4 Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional Practice

The development of AI-driven medical imaging solutions must consider legal, ethical, and professional standards to ensure trust, fairness, and compliance. **Data privacy and security** require adherence to GDPR and HIPAA regulations, with secure data storage and encryption to prevent breaches (Al-Okaily, 2020; Chia and Seng, 2025). **Bias and fairness** are addressed through diverse datasets and fairness-aware learning to prevent diagnostic disparities (Bunnell and Sargeant, 2023).

Explainability and trustworthiness are improved using Grad-CAM and Transformer Attention Maps, improving transparency for medical professionals (Karimzadeh, 2023). **Ethical AI deployment** follows FAT-ML principles, ensuring human oversight to prevent AI over-reliance (Madhu and Malapati, 2024). **Regulatory compliance and validation** with FDA



and EMA guidelines are crucial, with radiologists aiding external validation for robustness (Ferreira, 2023).

Professional responsibility represents fairness, accountability, and transparency, preventing AI misinterpretation in diagnostics (Hossain and Kumar, 2023). By addressing these challenges, this project aims to create a secure, ethical, and clinically viable AI system for breast cancer detection in ultrasound imaging.

5 Planning

Project Timeline:

Phase	Task	Duration
Research Ideation	Topic finalization, proposal drafting	Jan 18 - Feb 11
Literature Review	Reviewing related works, refining objectives	Feb 2 - Feb 11
Dataset Preparation	Data collection, preprocessing, annotation	Feb 11 - Feb 18
Model Development	CNN-Transformer architecture implementation	Feb 18 - Feb 25
Model Training & Testing	Hyperparameter tuning, performance evaluation	Feb 25 - Mar 4
Implementing Grad-CAM & XAI techniques	Explainability integration	Mar 4 - Mar 8
Full-Stack Platform Development	Backend (Python), Frontend (React), Database (MySQL)	Feb 11 - Apr 1
Validation & Comparison	Benchmarking against existing models	Mar 8 - Mar 20
Report Writing & Review	Dissertation drafting & revisions	Feb 11 - Apr 15

Figure 5-Research Timeline

Risk Assessment:

- **Computational Constraints:** Large-scale deep learning models require high-end GPUs (Chia & Seng, 2025).
- **Data Availability:** Limited labelled datasets for segmentation tasks.
- **Clinical Adoption Challenges:** Acceptance by radiologists and hospitals (Bunnell & Sargeant, 2023).

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Annex A – Schedule of Work Gantt Chart



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